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Chief Guest

Thiru B Rajkumar

Minister for Housing and Urban Development,
Government of Tamil Nadu

Session 1 - 10:50 am to 11:20 am

Fireside Chat:

Building the Next Decade:
The New Growth Blueprint for Real Estate

Mr Arun M N, Managing Director, Casagrand
Moderated by Mr L V Navaneeth, CEO, The Hindu Group

Session 2 - 11:25 am to 12:25 pm

The New Growth Triangle:
Manufacturing, GCCs & Real Estate

Ms Kanchana Krishnan, Commercial Head, ANAROCK
Mr Julian Francis, Associate Director, RMZ
Mr Arun Prasad, Principal Architect, Arun & Associates, Coimbatore
Mr Sabareeswaran, Senior Vice President, Leasing & Business
Development, Casagrand Commercial
Moderated by Ms Soundariya Preetha, Deputy Chief of Bureau
(Coimbatore), The Hindu

Session 3 - 12:30 pm to 1:30 pm

Beyond the City Limits: Why Peripheral Chennai
is Becoming the New Investment Destination

Mr Navin Kumar (Viswajith), Managing Director, Navin's
Mr Jerry Kingsley, Head of Research, India & City Lead for Capital Markets,
JLL Chennai
Mr Habib W S, Managing Director, RWD
Mr Gautam Agarwal, Chief Operating Officer, Casagrand
Moderated by Ms Sangeetha Kandavel, Senior Assistant Editor, The Hindu

Lunch - 1:30 pm to 2:30 pm

Session 4 - 2:35 pm to 2:55 pm

Student Presentation:

India's Vertical Forest Cities:
Integrate Skyscrapers with Urban Farming,
Biodiversity Corridors, Carbon Sequestration,
and Cooling Landscapes

Ms Subhapradha P R, B.Arch, Final Year Student, Saveetha College of
Architecture & Design

Water - Positive Cities: Solving Urban Water Crisis
Through Architecture

Mr Aldrich Bennet M, B.Arch, Final Year Student, Saveetha College of
Architecture & Design

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Session 5 - 3:00 pm to 4:00 pm

Building Economic Cities, Not Just Real Estate:
The Future of Integrated Urban Development

Dr Jothilakshmy Nagammal, Principal, Saveetha College of Architecture & Design
Mr Arun Bharathi, Managing Director, GTB Urban Developers
Ms Pavithra, Co-Founder, Design Co Lab
Mr B L Ravi Kumar, General Manager - Network - 1, State Bank of India
Moderated by Mr Prince Frederick, Civic Affairs Editor, The Hindu

Session 6 - 4:05 pm to 4:35 pm

Fireside Chat:

Land as the Next Asset Class: Why Plotted
Developments are Leading Tamil Nadu's Growth

Mr MV Manikandan, Founder & CMD, Adissia Developers
Moderated by Ms Soundariya Preetha,
Deputy Chief of Bureau (Coimbatore), The Hindu

Session 7 - 4:40 pm to 5:10 pm

Fireside Chat:

Why Tamil Nadu is Emerging as India's
Next GCC Powerhouse

Mr Venkat Neelakantan, Senior Vice President - Head Asset &
Facilities Management, K Raheja Corporation, Mindspace REIT.
Moderated by Mr Jerry Kingsley, Head of Research, India & City Lead
for Capital Markets, JLL Chennai

Session 8 - 5:15 pm to 6:15 pm

Luxury Housing Boom: How Architecture is
Redefining Premium Living

Mr Faisal Manzur, Founder and Principal Architect, Faisal Manzur Design Studio
Mr Kruthivas, Managing Director, Pushkar Properties Private Limited
Mr Deepak Jawahar, Architect & Co-Founder, The Architecture Story
Ms Sruti Reddy, Principal Architect & Creative Director, Ceebros Design Works
Moderated by Ms Sangeetha Kandavel, Senior Assistant Editor, The Hindu

Session 9 - 6:20 pm to 6:50 pm

Fireside Chat:

Beyond Bricks & Mortar: Why Risk Protection
is Critical to Modern Infrastructure

Mr V N Sandeep, Deputy General Manager, United India Insurance
Moderated by Mr Kunal Shankar, Deputy Business Editor, The Hindu

Session 10 - 6:55 pm to 7:35 pm

Building the Future: How AI and Emerging
Technologies are Transforming Construction

Mr Anson Sando, Co-Founder / Director - Elementech Circle, IIT Madras
Mr Ranjeeth Rathod, Managing Director, DRA Homes
Mr Santoshraj C S, Managing Partner, KeyStone Spaces
Moderated by Mr Kunal Shankar, Deputy Business Editor, The Hindu

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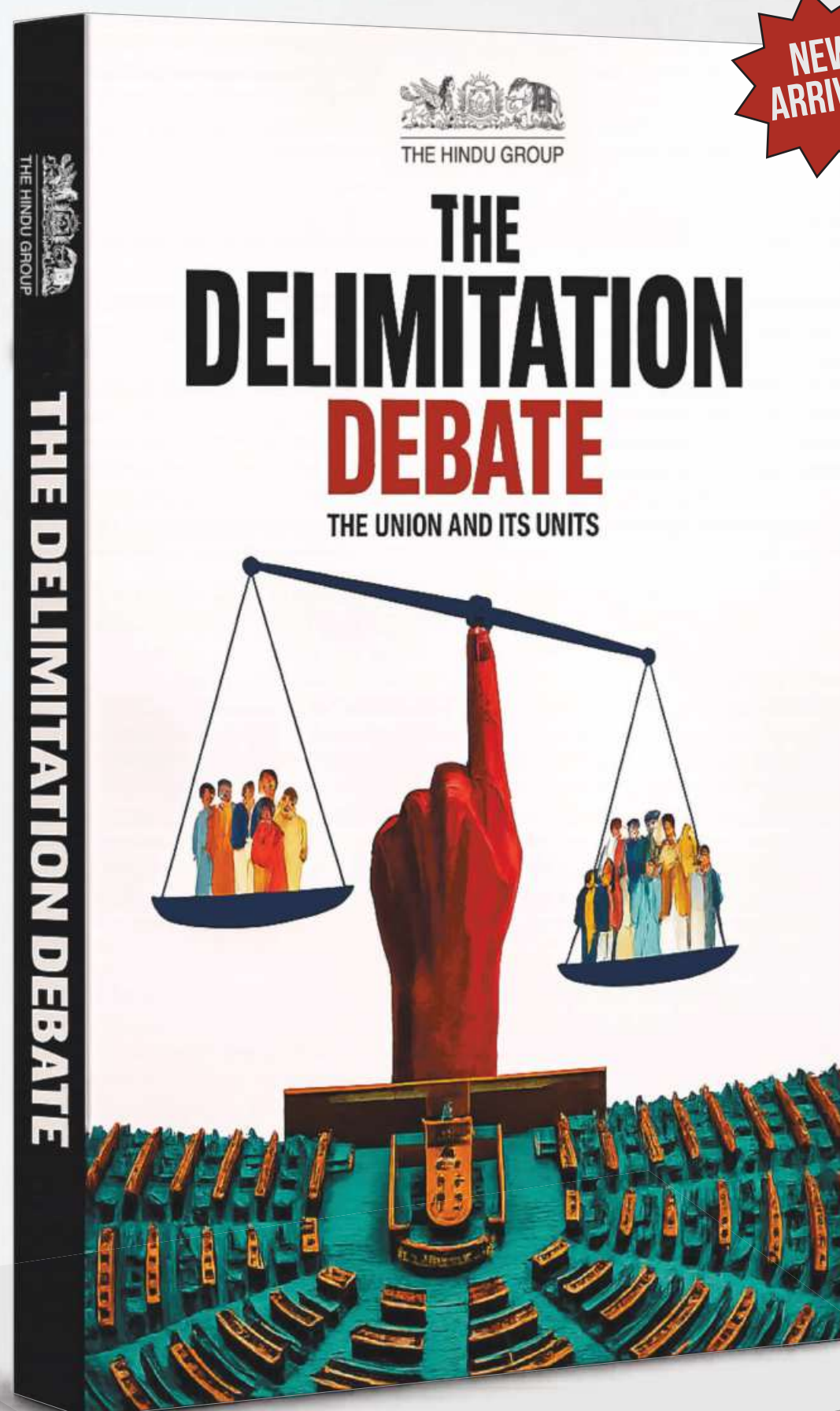
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Centre reissues draft for eco-sensitive zone

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Karnataka told to release water to T.N. for 15 days

STATES » PAGE 3



MAJOR EARTHQUAKE

Many people feared trapped in Japan mall

WORLD » PAGE 14

OPPORTUNITIES » PAGE 5

Release all minors held over student protests: SC

Top court mulls independent probe into allegations of police excesses during the protests; States permitted to proceed with probes, police restrained from taking 'coercive action' against students

Aaratrika Bhaumik
NEW DELHI

The Supreme Court on Tuesday indicated that it would consider constituting a high-powered investigation team to conduct a “thorough, fair, and independent” inquiry into allegations of police excesses during the recent student protests in Delhi and several States. While permitting the State authorities to proceed with the investigation of the FIRs registered in relation to the protests, the court ordered the immediate release of all minors arrested in connection with the demonstrations and restrained the police from taking coercive action against “protesting students” unless they had criminal antecedents.



Whosoever has committed excess, committed atrocities on innocent people, the law will take care of them. For that, there needs to be a completely independent and fair investigation... Probe is meaningless if no responsibility is fixed

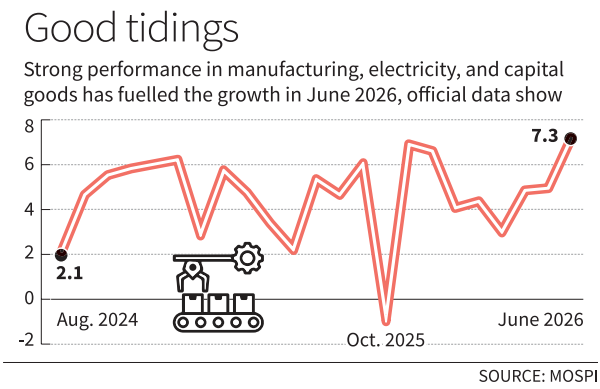
SURYA KANT
Chief Justice of India

The interim order permitting the authorities to proceed with the investigation of the existing FIRs raised concerns among the protesters on Tuesday, with the Cockroach Janta Party (CJP), which led the demonstrations, contending that the direction was contrary to the Centre's assurance that no punitive action would be taken

against protesters. Saurav Das, the CJP's spokesperson, said in a post on X that the order “raises extremely serious concerns” and is in “direct contradiction” to the Centre's assurance to the “youth of this nation”.

Underlining that the Constitution guarantees the right to peaceful protest, a Bench headed by Chief Justice of India (CJI)

Industrial growth hits 23-month high of 7.3%



T.C.A. Sharad Raghavan
NEW DELHI

India's industrial growth hit a near two-year peak of 7.3% in June 2026, fuelled by strong performance in manufacturing, electricity, and capital goods, official data released on Tuesday showed.

Analysts, however, caution that this strong performance might not continue in the face of a lower-than-expected monsoon and continued uncertainty due to the war in West Asia.

The data on the Index of Industrial Production (IIP), released by the Ministry of Statistics and Programme Implementation, showed that the index's growth in June was the fastest since July 2024, a 23-month high.

The index had grown 5.1% in May 2026. Within the index, the manufacturing sector grew at a 23-month high of 7.8% in June 2026, compared with 5.5% in May, and 2.4% in June of last year.

CONTINUED ON
» PAGE 10



NEXA

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INBRIEF



L-G lays foundation stone for city's first dedicated dog shelter

Lieutenant-Governor (L-G) Taranjit Singh Sandhu on Tuesday laid the foundation stone for Delhi's first dedicated dog shelter in Dwarka, a year after the Supreme Court directed authorities to move aggressive and rabies-suspected stray dogs into such facilities. The Municipal Corporation of Delhi will build the facility in Sector-29, Dwarka, on 6,050 square metres of land. It is expected to be operational by the end of November, an official said.

Delhi Police attempted to arrest Aishe Ghosh, alleges SFI

The Students' Federation of India (SFI) on Tuesday alleged that the Delhi police attempted to arrest its national joint secretary Aishe Ghosh in connection with a 2021 protest case. "SFI national joint secretary Aishe, who was one of the leading student leaders of the recent wave of protests that resulted in the resignation of Dharmendra Pradhan, is being subjected to witch-hunting by the Delhi police," the SFI stated in a release.

HC refuses to shift probe from officer seen 'slapping' woman

The Delhi High Court on Tuesday declined to transfer a 2025 probe into allegations of police excesses from the supervision of Additional DCP Sandeep Lamba, who was seen in a video allegedly slapping a woman during the July 20 protest, observing that an officer cannot be presumed to be biased in every matter because of allegations arising from another incident. "Just because he is caught on some video clip slapping a lady, we cannot tarnish him," Justice Girish Kathpalia said.

Stop witch-hunt of students or brace for new stir: CJP to govt.

Concerned that Centre, State govts. might 'weaponise' SC order: CJP; Delhi Police remains tight-lipped on withdrawal of FIRs filed during 36-day stir

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

A day after warning of fresh protests over the Centre's alleged violation of the assurance that no punitive action would be taken against protesters, Cockroach Janta Party (CJP) founder Abhijeet Dipke on Tuesday called on the government to stop "targeting and witch-hunting" students.

"If the harassment of students at the hands of the police continues, the Cockroach Janta Party will respond with a massive peaceful protest soon," he posted on X.

The Bihar government said it had withdrawn FIRs against protesters registered before 6 p.m. on July 26, and the governments of Assam and West Bengal have followed suit. However, there has been no word from Delhi Police on the issue so far.

When reached for comment, the Delhi Police PRO declined to comment. Deputy Commissioner of Police (New Delhi) Sachin Sharma said, "We have not received any orders or official communication to withdraw the FIRs yet."

The police have not made any arrests related to the Delhi protest so far. A total of 14 FIRs were registered and 600 people were



Protesters celebrating at Jantar Mantar on July 25 after hearing about Dharmendra Pradhan's resignation. SHASHI SHEKHAR KASHYAP

detained and subsequently released in the South East district where the prohibitory orders were imposed.

On July 25, the 36th day of the protest, the CJP called off its stir after the Centre agreed to its three main demands – ouster of Dharmendra Pradhan as the Union Education Minister, compensation for the families of those who ended their lives after the cancellation of NEET on May 3, and withdrawal of FIRs against the protesters and an assurance that no future action would be taken against them.

'Credible apprehension' The CJP also expressed concern over the Supreme Court's directions on Tuesday allowing State authorities to proceed with the investigation of the FIRs registered in connection with the protests.

"We now have a credi-

ble apprehension that the Government of India and BJP-ruled states may seek to use and weaponise this order of the Bench led by Chief Justice of India Surya Kant to continue FIRs against individual protesters and subject them to great harassment. This was precisely our concern from day one: that courts could be used, directly or indirectly, to achieve political ends by targeting peaceful dissent," CJP's chief spokesperson Saurav Das stated in a post on X.

Later in the day, Mr. Das said the Centre had not yet fulfilled its promise to share by Tuesday night the written assurance of the agreement they reached three days ago.

"They met me in the evening and conveyed the court order. I shared my objections. There has been no response from them after that," he said.



Commuters wading through a waterlogged road in New Delhi on Tuesday; (below) a view of Jama Masjid. SHASHI SHEKHAR KASHYAP/PTI

Heavy rain leaves city waterlogged, triggers AAP-BJP war of words

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

The Aam Aadmi Party (AAP) and the ruling Bharatiya Janata Party (BJP) locked horns over waterlogging after heavy rain lashed the national capital on Tuesday, leaving several parts of the city inundated.

AAP Delhi president Saurabh Bharadwaj said, "In Sadar Bazar, one of Delhi's largest wholesale markets, schoolchildren are being forced to pass through waist-deep rainwater. Thank you, CM Rekha Gupta. After Gen Z, now Gen Alpha, too, will remain indebted to the BJP."

Hitting back, Delhi BJP president Harsh Malhotra claimed that barring 2025, the city had witnessed waterlogging every monsoon for the past 27 years even after light rain.

He said the BJP government has "almost freed the city from the waterlogging problem".

Meanwhile, Chief Minister Rekha Gupta, accompanied by senior officials, travelled on a Delhi Transport Corporation bus to assess



the ground situation and review key civic works.

The Chief Minister began the inspection from her camp office in Civil Lines and travelled by bus via the Outer Ring Road and Madhuban Chowk to the DDA Sports Complex in Sector 33, Rohini.

She also reviewed the progress of waste disposal operations at landfill sites along the route.

57.6 mm rainfall

The Safdarjung weather station recorded 57.6 mm of rainfall till 5.30 p.m., according to the weather department. Civic authorities responded to at least 136 complaints related to waterlogging, uprooted trees and power outages.

HC has no jurisdiction to stay eviction of Gymkhana Club: Centre

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

The Centre has opposed a plea before the Delhi High Court seeking a stay on eviction proceedings against the Delhi Gymkhana Club, contending that the court lacks jurisdiction to entertain the application.

In its reply to an interim plea by club member Vijay Khurana, the Centre on Monday said that Section 15 of the Public Premises (Eviction of Unauthorised Occupants) Act creates a "two-fold" bar by excluding civil courts from proceedings relating to eviction from public premises and prohibiting the grant of "any injunction in respect of any action taken or to be taken by the Estate Officer".

The dispute stems from the Centre's decision in May to terminate the Delhi Gymkhana Club's perpetual lease, stating that the land is required for defence infrastructure and other security purposes. Mr. Khurana and the club's Staff Welfare Association have challenged the move before the High Court.

The case came up before Justice Avneesh Jhingan on Tuesday. Senior advocate Abhishek Manu Singhvi, representing Mr. Khurana, submitted that the Centre's reply had been served late on Monday night, and sought time to file a rejoinder. The court granted the request and listed the matter for September 3.

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NATIONAL HINDI DEBATE

Delhi Public School, Rohini, hosted 'Vicharvithi 2026', the Inter-DPS Hindi Debate (National Level), under the aegis of the Delhi Public School Society. Students from 114 Delhi Public Schools participated, with 22 finalist teams reaching the Grand Finale. Principal Mrs. Kanika Sachdeva Govi welcomed the gathering and highlighted the importance of language and identity. Mrs. Dolly Chanana, Director, Delhi Public School Society and National Convenor, and Ms. Ambikaa Kaul graced the event. Mrs. Dolly Chanana appreciated the school's efforts, and winners were honoured for their outstanding debating skills.

ALUMNI MEET HOSTED

Sachdeva Public School, Rohini, hosted an Alumni Meet, bringing together former students from the foundation years to the 2008 batch. Alumni reconnected with their classmates and teachers, revisited classrooms and shared their career journeys and memories. A highlight of the event was meeting the school's former Principal, whose guidance had inspired generations of students. Director Mr. Sanjay Sachdeva and Principal Dr. Namita Sharma said the alumni's achievements reflected the school's vision and encouraged them to remain connected, mentor future generations and contribute to the institution's continued growth.

SPELL BEE SUCCESS

Seth Anandram Jaipuria School, Kanpur, celebrated the achievements of their students in the Spell Bee International Competition 2025-26. At the International Stage, students displayed outstanding language proficiency, confidence and analytical skills. Mhd. Arafat Khan (Grade III, CISCE) and India Tasmeen Rahman (Grade II, CIE) secured the shared First National Rank in their respective categories. Zain Amir Mahmood (Class III), Advit Khaitan (Class V) and Tanish (Class VI) secured Fifth International Rank, while Raghav Gupta (Class IX) achieved Second International Rank. All rank holders will be felicitated with trophies and gift hampers.

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GOVERNMENT OF JAMMU & KASHMIR
OFFICE OF THE EXECUTIVE ENGINEER
IRRIGATION DIVISION KULGAM (192231)

Invitation for Bids (Notice Inviting Tenders)
e-NIT No. 07 of 2026-27 Dated:- 25-07-2026

For and on behalf of the Lt. Governor, UT of J&K, e-tenders (in two cover system) are invited on Percentage Rate basis from approved and eligible bidders as defined in the SBD for the following works:-

S. No	Title	Details
1.	Name of the Work	MODERNIZATION OF NANDI CANAL.
2.	Source of Funds / Scheme Code	NABARD LOAN Assistance (Irrigation Sector I&FC Kashmir, MH - 4702)
3.	Estimated Cost	₹1835.35 Lacs
4.	Position of Administrative Approval	Accorded vide Govt. order No. 289-JK (JSD) of 2025 Dated:16-12-2025, issued vide endstt. No. KIFCD-DBDDPRN/3/2025-6-CE I&FC KASHMIR (e-7702934), Dated 16.12.2025.
5.	Position of Technical Sanction	Accorded vide Chief Engineer Kmr. I&FC Department Srinagar's order No. 96-DB of 2025-26 dt. 30.01.2026 issued vide endorsement No. CE/DB/TS/17/128-29 Dated 30-01-2026.
6.	Position of Funds	Assured
7.	Period of Completion	(03) Three years
8.	Cost of Tender Document	₹ 10,000/- Tender document fee is to be deposited from any Scheduled bank as per Govt. of J&K Finance Department (Codes Division) Circular No: FD-Code/290/2026 dated:22/05/2026. The designated Account number as communicated vide Chief Engineer Kmr. I&FC Department Srinagar's No:CE/I&FC/DB/6518-47 dated: 16/06/2026 is as under: Account Name: Chief Engineer Kashmir Irrigation & Flood Control Department Srinagar, Account No: 0367010200000608IFSC Code: JAKA0TANKEE Bank: J&K Bank Ltd. Tankipora Branch. (Payment receipt mentioning Transaction ID, Date and allied details shall be uploaded online).
9.	Website/portal address	https://jktenders.gov.in
10.	Earnest Money Deposit (in Lakhs)	₹ 36.707 Lacs The validity of the EMD should be 45 days beyond Bid Validity (120 + 45) days.
11.	Selection Criteria /Eligibility Criteria	As defined in SBD of this work
12.	Period of Tender Validity	The Tender shall remain valid for 120 days after the bid submission end date.
13.	Critical Dates	
a)	Publishing date and time of tender Amendments documents	25/07/2026 Time; 06:00 PM
b)	Starting date & time for downloading of Tender documents	25/07/2026 Time; 06:00 PM
c)	Pre-Bid meeting, site visit and clarification to tender documents.	05/08/2026 Time:01:00 PM (In the office of Chief Engineer I&FC Kashmir, Sgr)
d)	Starting date and time of bid Submission (Cover No.1 to 2)	06/08/2026 Time; 10:00 AM
e)	Closing date and time of bid Submission (Cover No.1 to 2)	31/08/2026 Time; 10:00 AM
f)	Date and time of bid opening (Cover No.1)	01/09/2026 Time:01:00 PM (In the office of Chief Engineer I&FC Kashmir, Sgr)
g)	Date and time of bid opening (Cover No.2)	Will be intimated online after completion of evaluation of Technical Cover (Cover-I)

1. A Pre bid meeting will be held to clarify issues and to answer questions on any matter that may be raised at that stage by the bidders.

2. Prospective Bidders within UT of J&K shall submit/deposit the tender Document Fee (Non-Refundable/ Non- Transferrable) from any Scheduled bank as per Govt. of J&K Finance Department (Codes Division) Circular No: FD-Code/290/2026 dated: 22/05/2026. The designated Account number as communicated vides Chief Engineer Kmr. I&FC Department Srinagar's No: CE/I&FC/DB/6518-47 dated: 16/06/2026 is as under:
Account Name: Chief Engineer Kashmir Irrigation & Flood Control Department Srinagar.
Account No: 0367010200000608
IFSC Code: JAKA0TANKEE
Bank: J&K Bank Ltd. Tankipora Branch.

3. Earnest money/ Bid Security be also credited to the designated account mentioned in point No: 2. Same shall be valid for 120+45 days (i.e Not less than 165 Days) beyond bid validity.

4. Furnishing of hard copies of bids immediately after submission of e-tenders is dispensed with. The same shall be obtained only from the bidder who is declared as L1 after opening of financial bids as per Finance Department O.M. No. A/24(2017)-651DT: 07-06-2018.

5. The Contractor shall have to arrange all the key construction material for successful completion of the work. No Departmental material shall be issued.

6. Further details can be seen in bidding document available on website www.jktenders.gov.in

7. Conditional bids and the bids not meeting the qualifying criteria shall be summarily rejected.

8. The authority reserves the right to cancel any or all bids without assigning any reason.

9. Subsequent Corrigendum/Addendum if any shall be published on above website.

10. All other terms and conditions shall be same as laid down in the PWD Form-25 double & codal procedures shall be followed in accordance with GFR-2017 and the Procurement Manuals issued by the Ministry of Finance, Department of Expenditure, Government of India, as amended from time to time.

No: 2596-2611
Dated: 7/25/2026
DIPK- 3759/26.Jul 27 2026

Sd/-
Executive Engineer
Irrigation Division Kulgam.

Lakshmi Yojana to roll out on August 28; women with more than three children ineligible

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

Women with more than three children will not be eligible for the Delhi government's ₹2,500 monthly assistance under the Delhi Lakshmi Yojana, according to the additional eligibility criteria announced by the government on Tuesday.

According to an official release from the Chief Minister's Office (CMO), the government aims to release the first instalment of the assistance to nearly 17 lakh eligible women on Raksha Bandhan, which falls on August 28.

It quoted Chief Minister Rekha Gupta as saying that an online portal for applications would be launched on August 1.

According to the CMO, women

already receiving benefits under any other financial assistance scheme or pension, taxpayers, government employees, those who file GST, women with more than three living children and families with annual electricity consumption exceeding 2,400 units will not be eligible for the scheme.

Ms. Gupta said eligible women would have two options to receive the monthly assistance.

Under the first, ₹1,500 would be deposited in a recurring deposit (RD) or fixed deposit (FD) account while ₹1,000 would be credited to a digital rupee wallet.

"Under the second option, beneficiaries may choose to receive the entire ₹2,500 in an RD/FD. This option is intended to help women build savings," she added.

GOVERNMENT OF TAMIL NADU
TAMBARAM CITY MUNICIPAL CORPORATION

ROC.NO.272/2026/E1 **NOTICE FOR NATIONAL INVITING TENDER** Date :27.07.2026

1. Tenders are invited from the eligible bidders for following work:
i Providing Breakfast under Perunthalaivar Kamarajar Breakfast Scheme to Students studying from Classes I to VIII in Government Schools and Government Aided Schools for a period of three years in TCMC.

2. Value of the work is **Rs.1287.10 Lakhs**

3. The details of the tender shall be downloaded from **03.08.2026** from the portal <https://tn.tenders.gov.in>

4. The last date for downloading the tender document and the last date for uploading/ submission of filled up tender document is up to **3.00 pm on 03.09.2026.**

5. The received tenders will be opened at **3.30pm on 03.09.2026** at Tambaram Corporation Main Office.

6. Pre-Bid Meeting will be held at **11.00 Am on 17.08.2026** at Tambaram Corporation Main Office.

7. The value of work, the details of earnest money deposit, and eligibility of bidders are given in the tender document.

Commissioner,
Tambaram City Municipal Corporation

DIPR/2380/Tender/2026

DELHI TRANSCO LIMITED

EMPLOYMENT NOTICE

Delhi Transco Limited, a wholly owned Company of Government of NCT of Delhi, invites applications for appointment on Deputation Basis to one post of General Manager (Finance) (Pay Level-15) (Rs. 1,88,200-2,24,100) alongwith usual allowances as admissible under the rules of the Company.

For eligibility criteria, terms and conditions and complete details, please logon to the Company website: www.dtl.gov.in under the head "Career", or in Employment News.

INBRIEF



Sharad Pawar puts an end to speculations on NCP merger

NCP (SP) leader Sharad Pawar on Tuesday put an end to speculations about the likely merger between the Nationalist Congress Party (SP) faction and Sunetra Pawar-led NCP group. “It has no relevance,” he said, while speaking to reporters in Baramati. The statement assumes significance against the backdrop of reports of likely talks between the two factions. Over the last few months, several leaders had said that it was deceased NCP leader Ajit Pawar’s last wish to see both the parties together.

No paper leak case in Punjab, Oppn. lying; Minister Cheema

Punjab Finance Minister Harpal Singh Cheema on Tuesday rejected the Opposition’s charge of a paper leak in the State, claiming that it is trying to spread lies against the AAP government. Addressing the media here, Mr. Cheema said there has been no paper leak in the past four years of the Bhagwant Mann government. Opposition parties have been attacking the Mann government over the issue of a cheating racket detected recently in a pharmacy officer recruitment exam and are demanding the resignation of Education Minister Harjot Singh Bains and Health Minister Balbir Singh.

Police withdraw FIR filed suo motu against protesters in Kolkata

A city court grants bail to all 16 accused after initially remanding them in 2-day judicial custody; not applicable to persons with criminal past: govt.

Senjuti Sengupta
KOLKATA

Kolkata Police on Tuesday withdrew an FIR that it had filed suo motu against protesters for allegedly resorting to violence during a march on July 24 in the city’s Esplanade area in support of students agitating at Jantar Mantar in Delhi demanding the resignation of Dharmendra Pradhan as Union Education Minister.

After the police dropped the charges, the Chief Metropolitan Magistrate’s court granted bail to all 16 accused on a bond of ₹500. The accused were arrested from different places in and around the city. The court initially sent them to judicial custody till July 30.

The West Bengal Home and Hill Affairs Department later issued the formal order withdrawing the case. It clarified that no coercive measures shall be taken against the students who participated in the protest. However, the department also said, “The above protection shall not



The accused arrested in connection with violence during a protest on July 24 being produced before a court in Kolkata on Tuesday. ANI

extend to persons having criminal antecedents, as mandated in the order of the Hon’ble Court...”

Seven FIRs were registered in connection with the violence, including the suo motu case lodged by the police and six others filed on the basis of complaints made by journalists who suffered injuries while covering the July 24 march.

Chief Minister Suwendu Adhikari had earlier claimed that the accused will be booked under the newly passed West Bengal Public Safety and Control

of Anti-Social Activities Act, 2026, commonly called the ‘Goonda Act’.

‘Breach of agreement’ Kolkata Police’s decision to withdraw the FIR came a day after the Cockroach Janta Party, which spearheaded the protest in Delhi against the alleged NEET paper leak, said the Centre should not breach the agreement to withdraw all police cases against protesters. Similar FIRs registered against protesters in Assam and Bihar were withdrawn on Monday.

‘A lawyer in court dress, agents delivering food’: people who landed in Assam Police’s custody

The Hindu Bureau
GUWAHATI

On the afternoon of July 24, advocate Ariful Islam, 28, was standing near the site of a NEET paper leak protest in Guwahati when policemen stopped by and took him into custody. They later registered his arrest at 9 p.m. on that day.

“What is most alarming is that, at the time of his detention, he (Mr. Islam) was in the court dress of an advocate and repeatedly identified himself as a member of the Bar, producing his Bar Council identity card before the police personnel present at the spot,” read a statement issued by the Assam unit of the All India Lawyers Association for Justice.

The arrested advocate, it added, was merely a bystander at the protest venue in Guwahati.

On the same day, 23-year-old Mustahid Ahmed was also arrested after he reportedly asked a policeman outside the protest venue why his name tag was missing from his uniform.

Mr. Islam and Mr. Ahmed were two of five persons held in Guwahati on that day. The other three were Chinmoy Deka, a 24-year-old student, and



Security personnel detaining a demonstrator protesting against the NEET paper leak in Guwahati on July 25. ANI

food delivery agents Amir Ali, 26, and Mehdi Alam, 26. A member of the lawyers’ association said the two food delivery agents had nothing to do with the protest.

The Assam government has now withdrawn five cases leading to the arrest of 13 people who participated in the protests against the NEET examination paper leak, announcing that the “matter shall be treated as closed”.

In an order issued late Monday night, the police said no adverse action would be taken against the protesters. It also said the process to review the arrest of the 13 people picked up on July 23 and 24 was being expedited.

The Guwahati arrests came a day after a Students’ Federation of India

(SFI) protest on July 23 in solidarity with activist Sonam Wangchuk and agitating students nationwide seeking education reforms.

Among the others, three students were arrested in Lakhimpur, while Congress leader Birinchi Bora was held in Nagaon town.

Most of them were booked under penal sections dealing with criminal conspiracy; endangering the sovereignty, unity and integrity of India; endangering human life or personal safety; using criminal force to stop a public servant from doing his or her job; wrongful confinement; rioting and unlawful assembly; and publishing or circulating false statements.

The government’s latest decision followed the release of more than 50 people detained on July 25.

Echoes of Jantar Mantar in U.P. as ‘Gen Alpha’ school students stage protest for basic facilities

Ishita Mishra
NEW DELHI

Days after the Cockroach Janta Party-led student protest in Delhi drew national attention, a similar expression of dissent emerged from Uttar Pradesh’s Fatehpur district on Tuesday, when hundreds of students at a government-aided school walked out of their classrooms and staged a protest demanding better infrastructure.

The school administration called police personnel to maintain order.

Videos from the protest, which gained wider attention after being shared by Chandrashekhar Azad, Nagina MP and president of the Azad Samaj Party (Kanshi Ram), and Aam Aadmi Party, show police asking students to clear the road, even as the demonstrators continue marching.



Students said midday meals had never been served as per rules. SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

The demonstration took place at Sarvodaya Inter College, a government-aided school with nearly 1,800 students, in Kishanpur town. Students marched through the locality holding portraits of B.R. Ambedkar and carrying placards that read: ‘College ki vyavastha sudharo, bachchon ka bhavishya sanwaro’ (Improve the college’s condition, secure the future of its students)’.

Abhishek Sonkar, a student, alleged that midday meals had never been served in accordance with the prescribed menu.

In his post, the Nagina MP alleged that repeated representations to the school administration had failed to bring about any meaningful change. He concluded the post with the slogan, ‘Jai Bhim! Jai Gen Alpha!’

‘Attended Delhi protest’ Principal of the school, L.B. Singh, told *The Hindu* that several demands, including the installation of four fans in each classroom, a water cooler and the provision of meals as per the prescribed menu, had been addressed immediately. He added that a few students from the higher grades were learnt to have participated in the protest at Jantar Mantar.

Students involved in NEET paper leak agitation facing police crackdown, says AISA

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

The All India Students’ Association (AISA) on Tuesday alleged that protesters involved in the agitation against the NEET paper leak are facing a police crackdown across the country.

The students’ body claimed that multiple SFI activists, including former JNUSU president Dhananjay, AISA Bihar secretary Dipankar Mishra, and Patna University activists Divyam Kumar and Saba Afreen, have been arrested in Bihar.

AISA national president Neha, one of the prominent faces during the protest, said during a press conference at the Press Club of India: “We were assured that students protesting peacefully would not face



AISA national president Neha (left) and DU unit secretary Anjali addressing the media in New Delhi on Tuesday. SUSHIL KUMAR VERMA

repression. However, what we have witnessed is continued arrests, arbitrary detentions and intimidation of students across the country. The government must uphold its promises, release those detained and engage with the concerns of students.”

In addition to arrests made in Bihar, West Bengal and Jharkhand, AISA said that protesters were sent notices in Delhi’s Jamia Na-

gar. “It has come to our notice that in Jamia Nagar, student peotesters are being sent notices based on retina and face scanning for their presence at Jantar Mantar. AISA Jamia has issued a helpline for legal aid in the matter,” AISA said in a statement.

The organisation reiterated its demand to release all protesters and give compensation for those injured in police brutality.

Withdraw all cases against students: Pinarayi to Kerala CM

The Hindu Bureau
THIRUVANANTHAPURAM

Leader of the Opposition in Kerala Assembly Pinarayi Vijayan has written to Chief Minister V.D. Satheesan demanding an unconditional withdrawal of all cases filed in the State against those who took to the streets to express solidarity with the Jantar Mantar students’ agitation.

The office of the Chief Minister on Tuesday informed that Mr. Vijayan’s letter has been forwarded to the Home Department for further action.

In his letter, Mr. Vijayan said that

while the Chief Minister himself was seen joining the protests at Jantar Mantar, alongside the Leader of the Opposition in the Lok Sabha Rahul Gandhi, it is inappropriate that the very government he leads in

Reports indicate that the police have booked cases against nearly 5,000 people for staging protests

Kerala has charge-sheeted many who agitated in Kerala to support the students.

He also pointed out that there are complaints that false cases were being foisted against many who took part in peaceful protests.

Reports indicate that the Kerala police have booked cases against nearly 5,000 people across various parts of the State for participating in these protests. As the Centre has agreed to withdraw all cases against students, the United Democratic Front government should not delay in withdrawing the cases filed by the Kerala police, Mr. Vijayan said.

BJP bids to stave off JSP, RJD challenge as campaigning ends for Bankipur byelection

Amit Bhelari
PATNA

Campaigning for the July 30 Bankipur Assembly byelection in Bihar came to a close on Tuesday, with candidates making a final push to secure the seat vacated by BJP national president Nitin Nabin following his election to the Rajya Sabha in April.

The BJP is making an all-out effort to retain the seat and has fielded 32-year-old youth wing leader Neeraj Kumar Sinha as its candidate. The bypoll will mark the electoral debut of Prashant Kishor, the 49-year-old founder of the Jan Suraj Party (JSP), which failed to win any seat in the Assembly poll last year.

The Opposition Rashtriya Janata Dal (RJD) has nominated Rekha Kumari,



JSP candidate Prashant Kishor addressing a rally and BJP’s Neeraj Kumar Sinha meeting voters in Bankipur on Tuesday. AMIT BHELARI

who was the runner-up from the seat in the Assembly poll that was won by Mr. Nabin by a margin of over 50,000 votes. RJD working president Tejashwi Yadav joined the party’s campaign only on Monday. Although 25 candidates are in the fray, the contest appears to be primarily between the BJP and the



JSP. The Bankipur constituency has nearly four lakh voters. The Kayasth and Yadav communities together account for about 25% of the electorate. Muslims and Chandravanshis also have sizeable numbers, with both communities constituting nearly 20% of the voters. The Vaishya, Dalit, Bhumihar, Rajput,

Brahmin, Kurmi, and Kushwaha communities each make up between 3% and 8% of the electorate.

Key concerns

On the BJP candidate’s roadshow, Sanjay Gupta, a trader from Meethapur, said, “We are not looking at caste; for us, the candidate is more important.”

Voters also expressed concern over issues such as the NEET paper leak row and alleged theft of donations at Ram Temple.

Mr. Kishor addressed public meetings in Peermuhani, Sabzibagh, and Jai Prakash Nagar. Speaking to the gathering at Peermuhani, the JSP leader said, “When you go to cast the vote, think about the future of your children.”

The results will be declared on August 3.

Rain, reflections on Jantar Mantar protest mark Day 1 of DU’s new academic session

Antra Abhilasha
NEW DELHI

Delhi University’s (DU) new academic session opened on Tuesday to familiar sights – nervous freshers, returning seniors, and long registration queues.

Amid rain and low attendance, campuses buzzed with conversations around the recently concluded protest at Jantar Mantar.

Many who watched the stir unfold from outside Delhi or stayed back out of concern for their safety said they regretted not being present on the ground.

With the DU students’ union elections approaching, student organisations also began their campaigns with help desks and pamphlet distribution. Some students questioned the absence of the RSS-linked



Students of Miranda House enjoying the rain on Tuesday, the first day of Delhi University’s new academic session. SUSHIL KUMAR VERMA

Akhil Bharatiya Vidyarthi Parishad (ABVP) from the agitation. The ABVP had earlier defended its position, saying it was raising students’ issues through platforms other than the Jantar Mantar protest.

Outside the gates of Shri Ram College of Commerce, Soundarya, a fresher, expressed regret at not hav-

ing attended the stir at Jantar Mantar. “I couldn’t join the protest due to security concerns. It was a much-needed movement and I stand in support of the students who raised their voices,” she said.

Outside Daulat Ram College, Divya Dewana, a third-year student, reflected on watching the protest

unfold. “Seeing all the students, the Gen Z, come together was a good feeling. Everyone was speaking up for their rights, about what they found wrong, and asking for change,” she said.

‘Take strict action’

At the orientation session in the college, Shubhi Yadav, a third-year student, spoke about the brutality she witnessed. “Policemen harassed women and even beat schoolchildren. A child in Class 6 suffered a fractured leg,” she said.

“Labelling students demanding their right to education as ‘anti-nationals’ is unjust in a democracy. Strict action must be taken against the misconduct by the police,” she added.

A teacher said fewer students attended orientation sessions due to the rain.

RSS distances itself from Kerala Hindutva ideologue's remarks

The Hindu Bureau
KOCHI

The Rashtriya Swayamsevak Sangh has condemned the controversial remarks made by Hindutva ideologue T.G. Mohandas against the student protests at Jantar Mantar.

In a video posted on his YouTube channel, Mr. Mo-

handas had said that he "would have shot" the protesters if he were in control.

A former head of the BJP's Kerala intellectual cell, he said in another video that secular women who take part in protests "enjoy being gangraped."

K.B. Sreekumar, Saha Prantha Karyavah (South

Kerala) of the RSS, said in a statement that Mr. Mohandas's comments on the protests were "his personal thoughts and he is not an RSS official at any level".

He said the RSS did not agree with his views and "such views should be condemned in every highest possible manner".

Kerala teen affected by amoebic brain infection critical

The Hindu Bureau
KASARAGOD

Kasaragod district in Kerala has reported another case of amoebic menin-

goencephalitis (amoebic brain infection), with an 18-year-old testing positive for the rare but life-threatening disease. The teenager is in a critical condition at the

intensive care unit of a hospital in Mangaluru.

According to preliminary information, the teen had bathed, along with his friends, in a pond located

Real Creator IAS Edition <https://t.me/+8B98m5PQCf84MmQ9>

along the Kanhangad-Panathur State highway about a week ago. He developed health complications soon afterwards, and subsequent tests con-

firmed the infection.

The Health Department and the police issued a warning directing people not to bathe in the pond until further notice.



CHHATTISGARH HOUSING AND INFRASTRUCTURE DEVELOPMENT BOARD
DIVISION-3 MOULSHREE VIHAR, VIP ROAD, RAIPUR
(2nd Call)

Advt.No.399

Chhattisgarh Housing and Infrastructure Development Board invites the tender for "Selection of an Agency for Development, Operation and Maintenance of a top-end cosmopolitan Social and Health clubhouse "Queen's Club of India", located at VIP Road, Raipur, Chhattisgarh, on license, Development, Operation and Transfer (LDOT) basis on PPP mode".

For bid processing fee, bid security, eligibility criteria and other details as given in the RFP document, please visit the [website https://cghb.gov.in](https://cghb.gov.in) & <http://eproc.cgstate.gov.in> for details. The bidder may also contact the Executive Engineer, Chhattisgarh Housing and Infrastructure Development Board, Division-3, Moulshree Vihar, Raipur over contact number 9753266721/6265731603

Tenderers shall download tender from cge-procurement website.

- Date and Time of Pre-bid meeting:- at 12:00 PM on 06.08.2026 at Sector-19, Paryawas Bhawan, CGHIDB Head Office, Nava Raipur Atal Nagar
- Last Date and Time of online Pre-bid queries submission- on or before the above mentioned date & time.
- Last Date for Online submission of Tender - Till 03:00 PM on 13.08.2026

Note: Email id for submission of pre bid queries: cghbdiv03@gmail.com

The details of tender and terms & conditions are available on the e-Procurement website <https://eproc.cgstate.gov.in> Any amendment/corrigendum in the tender documents, will only be uploaded on the e-Procurement website and shall not be published in any newspaper.

Samvad-48569/5

EE, CGHIDB, Div-3 Raipur

OBITUARY & REMEMBRANCE

DEATH

OBITUARY



Shri. Balaram Venketaraman (86)

Coonor, attained Sadgati on July 21, 2026.

-In mourning-
Jaya, Anita, Sujatha, Apparna & Families.

Whatsapp @ +1-510-458-6462
Om Shanthi

NORTH EASTERN RAILWAY

E-Tender Notice

Dy. Chief Electrical Engineer, Mechanical Workshop, North Eastern Railway, Gorakhpur for & behalf of President of India Invites "OPEN" E-Tender through online (e-tendering) for the following work:

Tender Notice No.: EL-MWS-GKP-2026-27-08, Description of work: Provision of Copper Shrouded Bus Bar System at Fiat Bogie Shop in Mechanical Workshop, Gorakhpur. Approx. Value: ₹ 25,37,472/-, E.M.D. Money: ₹ 50,800/-, Cost of Tender Document: 0.00, Completion time/Period from the date of issue of acceptance letter: 02 Months.

- E-tender online will be submitted upto 11:00 hrs. on dated 17-08-2026.
- For full details and submission of bid please see the Indian Railway IREPS official website www.ireps.gov.in

Dy. Chief Electrical Engineer (WS)
CPRO/Vidyut-111 Gorakhpur

Never travel on roof and foot boards.



संचालनालय
खेल और युवा कल्याण
टी.टी. नगर स्टेडियम, भोपाल, मध्यप्रदेश

ई-निविदा सूचना

संचालनालय खेल और युवा कल्याण, मध्यप्रदेश, द्वारा वाटर स्पोर्ट्स सामग्री/उपकरण को सुरक्षित रखने के लिए कंटेनर प्रदाय एवं स्थापित करने हेतु निर्माता अथवा उनके अधिकृत प्रतिनिधि से ई-निविदा आमंत्रित की जाती है। निविदा प्रपत्र व निविदा की विस्तृत शर्तें www.mptenders.gov.in पर उपलब्ध है। ई-निविदा प्रकाशन उपरांत निविदा में कोई संशोधन व परिवर्तन किया जाता है तो वह मात्र उपरोक्त उल्लेखित ई-टेंडर पोर्टल पर ही उपलब्ध रहेगा।

म.प्र., माध्यम/127225/2026

संचालक





RAJASTHAN STATE INDUSTRIAL DEVELOPMENT & INVESTMENT CORPORATION LTD.
(A Rajasthan Government Undertaking)

Udyog Bhawan, Tilak Marg, Jaipur- 302005, Phone- 0141-2227751, 4593201
E-mail- riico@riico.co.in Website- riico.raajasthan.gov.in

TENDER NOTICE

RIICO invites sealed tenders/bids through eproc.raajasthan.gov.in for the following works/ services/supply etc.

Sr. No.	Office & Type of Work	Estimated Cost (Rs.in Lacs)
1.	Unit Head, Kota	
1.1	Development Works at Industrial Area Growth Park Deroli, Bundi. UBN-RDC2627WLR001029	941.07
1.2	Development Works at IGP Toy Park, Ranpur, Kota. UBN-RDC2627WS0800958	301.47
2.	Unit Head, Sawai Madhopur	
2.1	Improvement of Civil Infrastructure at Industrial Area IID Center Newai, Distt. Tonk. UBN-RDC2627WLO800923	903.45
3.	Unit Head, Jodhpur	
3.1	Construction of CC Road & Paving Road Shoulders with Interlocking CC Blocks at Industrial Area Basni Ph-II, Jodhpur. UBN-RDC2627WLO800965	638.63
4.	Unit Head, Nagaur	
4.1	Construction of Road & CD Works and RCC Plot Demarcation Pillars at Ind Area Khinwsar Nagaur. UBN-RDC2627WS0800926	295.73
5.	Unit Head, Jaipur(South)	
5.1	Removing and Re-Fixing of Precast Interlocking Tiles and Raising and Covering of Existing Drains at Industrial Area Apparel Park, Jaipur. UBN-RDC2627WS0800927	335.01
6.	Unit Head, Ajmer	
6.1	Development of Stone Mandi at Mothi, Tehsil Badnor, Ajmer. UBN-RDC2627WS0801019	226.80
7.	Unit Head, Dausa	
7.1	Development Works at Industrial Area Samleti (Dausa). UBN-RDC2627WS0800969	297.22
8.	Unit Head, Jaipur(Rural)	
8.1	Improvement of Drainage Network on Approach Road at Industrial Area Bagru (Extn.), Jaipur. UBN-RDC2627WS0800974	344.89
9.	Unit Head, Mandore	
9.1	Development Works at Industrial Area IGP Hajisagar, Tehsil Aau, Distt. Phalodi. UBN-RDC2627WLO801030	949.67

Bidders/contractors may download and submit tender online. Detailed information of tenders and any kind of corrigendum/ date extension, if any in future, may be seen by bidders on websites riico.raajasthan.gov.in, www.sppp.raajasthan.gov.in and www.eproc.raajasthan.gov.in

For queries please contact: GM (Civil) Ph. 0141-4593214 **Raj.Samvad/C/26/7905**



BIHAR SCHOOL EXAMINATION BOARD

NOTICE INVITING e-TENDER

Tender Notice No. : PR 171/2026

Bihar School Examination Board invites e-tenders under two bid systems from the reputed, experienced Firms /Companies/ Agencies/ Societies for "Supply& Printing of Variable Data on Pre-printed Blank Stationary Provided by BSEB and Tabulation Register for Matric and Inter Examination (Annual & Compartmental)-2027& Other Examinations." Detailed tender document containing eligibility criteria, other terms and conditions are available on the website <https://eproc2.bihar.gov.in>

Tender Schedule

Date and Time for Activity	Date/Time: Duration
Online Sale/ Download Date of Tender Documents	From: 29/07/2026 (16:00 Hrs.) to 19/08/2026 (16:00 Hrs.) (https://eproc2.bihar.gov.in)
Pre-Bid Meeting	07/08/2026 at 12:30 Hrs. (Bihar School Examination Board, Sinha Library Road, Patna-800017)
Last Date/ Time for Submission/ uploading of Online Bid	19/08/2026 up to 16:00 Hrs. (https://eproc2.bihar.gov.in)
Last Date and Time for Submission of EMD (Only in case of BG) / Samples	20/08/2026 up to 13:00 Hrs.
Date & Time for Opening of Technical Bid	20/08/2026 at 14:00 Hrs (https://eproc2.bihar.gov.in)
Date & Time for Opening of Financial Bid	Date to be announced later by Competent Authority.
Cost of the Tender Document	₹5,900/- (Five Thousand Nine Hundred Rupees Only) (Non-Refundable)
Tender Processing Fee	₹5,900/- (Five Thousand Nine Hundred Rupees Only) (Non-Refundable)
Earnest Money	₹1,00,000/- (One Lakh Rupees only) (Refundable)

- Contact Details: **Nodal Officer, Mobile No.: +91 62999 23095, E-Mail ID: eproc-bseb-bih@gov.in/eproc.bseb@gmail.com**
- Note:** Bihar School Examination Board reserves the right to accept/ cancel/ reschedule tenders without assigning any reasons. Prospective bidders are advised to regularly visit <https://eproc2.bihar.gov.in>. Corrigendum/ Amendments etc., if any, will be notified on this portal only and no separate advertisement will be made.

Secretary



HIMACHAL PRADESH PUBLIC WORKS DEPARTMENT
"CORRIGENDUM"

The time schedule for the work namely "Up-gradation of Link road Rait Nerti Balla Salwana- Tatwani Km. 0/00 to 17/048 (Portion 10/970 to 17/048) in Distt. Kangra (HP),(SH-Improvement, passing places, R/Walls, CD work, GSB, WBM-II, Tarring work, Paver Block, Side drainparapets and road sign etc.) including five year routine Maintenance). (under NABARD RIDF-XXVI)" as called vide this office letter No. PWD/SEV/ WS-VI/ NABARD/ RIDF-XXVI/ 2026-27/ 2625-35 dated 08/07/2026 is hereby extended, due to some Technical / Administrative reasons. The following key dates may be read as:-

Job No.	Dates already mentioned	Now may be read as
1.	Start date of downloading of bid: 15.07.2026 (10.00 AM)	25.07.2026 (10.00AM)
2.	Deadline for submission of bid: 28.07.2026 (5.00 PM)	15/08/2026 (05.00PM)
3.	Date of opening tenders: 29/07/2026 (11.30 AM)	17.08.2026 (11.30AM)

Others terms and conditions will remain unchanged. The bidders are advised to note other details of tenders from the departmental website <https://hptenders.gov.in>

Superintending Engineer,
5th Circle, HP PWD,
Palampur,

HP / 2221/26-27 **HIM SUCHANA AVAM JAN SAMPARK**



THE  HINDU

OPPORTUNITIES

GENERAL



KPR GROUP OF INSTITUTIONS
COIMBATORE

proposes to establish a University under
Distinct Category

Applications are invited for the position of

ADVISOR
UNIVERSITY ESTABLISHMENT

Who Should Apply?

- Retired Registrars of University
- Senior Administrators with significant experience in University administration and statutory compliance
- Send your resume to: career.kpruni@kpriat.ac.in

KPR Institute of Engineering and Technology
invites applications for

DEAN, SCHOOL OF COMPUTING

DIRECTOR, KPR BUSINESS SCHOOL

Qualifications and eligibility as per AICTE norms

Send your resume to career@kpriat.ac.in

Apply within 15 days from the date of advertisement

kpriat.edu.in  /KPRIATonline



राष्ट्रीय प्रौद्योगिकी संस्थान अरुणाचल प्रदेश
National Institute of Technology Arunachal Pradesh
(An Institute of National Importance under Ministry of Education, Govt. of India)

JOTE-791113, Arunachal Pradesh, www.nitap.ac.in

Advertisement No. NIT/AP/Estt-186/NTR/Add-01/2026
RECRUITMENT FOR FILLING UP VARIOUS NON-TEACHING POSITIONS

Applications are invited from eligible Indian Nationals for the various Non- Teaching positions. For further details, please visit the Institute website www.nitap.ac.in.

Opening of online application portal **01-08-2026** and the last date for submission of online application is **31-08-2026 up to 11:59 P.M.**

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CM YK  M ND-NDE



Protecting protest

Protests that inconvenience people must not be confused with violence

Defining feature of the recent Cockroach Janta Party agitation related to its under-estimation by the government, which hoped to quell the protests by force. The net result was widespread student anger, which served to entrench the agitation. The Supreme Court has just commenced hearing petitions on the police's alleged use of disproportionate force, especially on July 20 in Delhi and a constable's aerial firing of an assault rifle allegedly to disperse crowds on July 25 in Bihar's Siwan. The Court has also agreed to hear petitions from the families of police personnel claiming that they were assaulted and "lynched". The ferocity of the July 20 police crackdown against protesters is not in doubt; in addition to tear gas, videos also purported to show the police using lathis studded with nails. But as Justice Joymalya Bagchi observed, the state should also answer why some police officers allegedly lacked protective gear. Under-equipped police are more likely to escalate force out of fear, and this is why international best practices in crowd control involve graduated responses. There is also merit in pleas that the same police force accused of using excess force also investigating it could potentially undermine credibility.

However, the Chief Justice of India's remark that protests are permissible "with due permission and at designated places" could come at odds with the right to protest. The democratic purpose of a protest is to inconvenience the state and thus should not be limited to its happening at the state's convenience. At the same time, not every inconvenience is constitutionally protected. The answer lies in proportionality. If the CJI's insistence on 'discipline' comes to mean protests must be orderly and predictable, it risks imposing administrative preferences on a constitutional right. The state is responsible for preventing violence, protecting life, and maintaining essential services. But modern cities are also dense and even a peaceful blockade could deprive thousands of uninvolved citizens of their liberties. The judiciary should thus resist conflating disruption that results in inconveniencing the public – which is one of the mechanisms by which a protest acquires its political force – and violence, which infringes on the rights of others. A unified set of procedures will also be welcome since policing is a State subject under the Seventh Schedule, and States have different training, equipment, escalation, and documentation rules. A national protocol could standardise the thresholds at which the use of high-impact crowd-control measures can be authorised and mandatory documentation of lathi charges, medical assistance after use of force, preservation of evidence, and independent inquiries into serious injuries.

Diminishing relevance

The Commonwealth Games look increasingly like a relic from the past

As Olympic and World Championships medalist Mirabai Chanu stood atop the podium in Glasgow on Sunday, tears rolling down her cheeks after becoming the first woman weightlifter to secure her third consecutive Commonwealth Games gold medal, she provided much-needed succour to a Games that had risked fading into oblivion a few years ago. With India set to host the centenary edition of the Games in Ahmedabad in 2030, there could not have been a better advertisement than Mirabai's golden triumph, which also ensured her fourth medal of any colour in a row in the women's 48kg category with a total of 190kg. The seasoned weightlifter's feat may not be the only glorious chapter written in the Scottish city, as other leading Indian athletes are expected to climb the podium in athletics and para-athletics, weightlifting and para-weightlifting, boxing, judo, and lawn bowls and para-bowls. According to an internal estimation by the Union Sports Ministry, India's athletes are expected to win around 30 medals even though several disciplines in which Indians have traditionally excelled – such as wrestling, badminton, table tennis, hockey and squash – were dropped from the scaled-down Glasgow event. Medals are expected from Neeraj Chopra, Murali Sreesankar, Praveen Chithravel, and boxers Lovlina Borgohain and Jaismine Lamboria.

The curtailed Commonwealth Games highlights the diminishing relevance of the erstwhile British Empire's sporting tradition. The 2026 edition, originally allotted to Victoria, faced an existential threat after the Australian State withdrew as a host three years ago due to spiralling costs. Glasgow, the host in 2014, saved the Games from embarrassment by proposing a scaled-down version – with 10 integrated disciplines, across four venues within an eight-mile corridor. Even though the Commonwealth Games do not match the global or regional excellence of the Olympics or the Asian Games, the platform still holds a strong appeal for Indian sportspersons and administrators. While India's success at the elite world level across different sports has been sporadic, it has the dubious distinction of topping the global doping charts for three successive years. Multiple athletes across disciplines have been caught for consuming banned substances even in the run-up to Glasgow 2026. Either they have been withdrawn from the Indian contingent or have failed to qualify due to this, impacting the nation's medal chances and bringing it shameful international headlines. As the country prepares to organise a bigger Commonwealth Games – especially against the backdrop of the corruption-tainted Delhi 2010 edition – it would do well to enhance its vigilance to curb financial malpractices and promote clean sport over the next four years.

On June 22, 2026, 15 people gasped to death in a burning building in Aliganj, Lucknow. Trapped behind smoke-filled corridors and sealed exits, they never had a chance. The commercial establishment operating from a residential neighbourhood was a veritable death trap – pigeonhole-sized workstations crammed into an unauthorised structure with no viable fire escape.

It was not merely a building that caught fire, but a system that failed. A tragedy waiting to happen, aided by those whose job it was to prevent it.

All this happened, while the TV channels discussed animatedly U.S.-Iran parleys, where India played no role, and analysts dissected the number of Members of Parliament defecting to the Eknath Shinde-led Shiv Sena. Not aware if there was ever a mention of a collapse of political ethics and morality. But then, do ethics, morality and professionalism figure in urban governance today? Major fires have erupted in cities across India in 2026 on account of failures of urban regulation – signifying abject greed and mismanagement.

On June 3, a fire in a bed and breakfast facility, Malviya Nagar, Delhi, was also caused by illegal construction with no emergency exit. In February, a Bhiwadi garment plant, Rajasthan, which caught fire was an illegal firecracker-manufacturing unit behind closed doors; the fire in a cracker manufacturing unit in Virudhunagar, Tamil Nadu, took place when the factory was running illegally on a Sunday.

Yet, amidst the horror, emerged stories of extraordinary courage. In Delhi's Malviya Nagar fire, a mattress shop owner reportedly emptied his entire stock onto the street to cushion those jumping from the burning building. Young residents rushed forward without waiting for instructions, while police personnel administered CPR, evacuated victims and continued rescue efforts despite injuries to themselves. Such acts of humanity stand in sharp contrast to the institutional failures.

Historical data trends suggest that India sees approximately 13,000-15,000 fire deaths annually, with the summer of 2026 projected to be one of the worst due to extreme heatwaves triggering electrical fires. In the first quarter of 2026, 39 people have died in fires in Delhi alone, even before the summer peak began.

Violations without consequences

The problem extends far beyond Aliganj and Malviya Nagar. Death traps of varying forms exist in countless urban settlements across India. They may differ in appearance but share a common characteristic: everyone knows the violations exist, yet they continue.

This is what makes the present crisis particularly troubling when India today possesses technological capabilities unimaginable even a decade ago. Satellite imagery can identify encroachments. Drones can map illegal



Yashovardhan Azad

Retired Indian Police Service officer, who has served as the Central Information Commissioner, Secretary – Security, Government of India, and Special Director, Intelligence Bureau

Urban neglect, political apathy, and corruption continue to claim lives across India

constructions. Geographic Information Systems can track land use changes. Digital property databases can identify violations. Artificial intelligence can flag anomalies and real-time dashboards can monitor compliance.

Is it really difficult for a municipal commissioner, a development authority official, a State government functionary or the Lieutenant Governor to call for a list of establishments operating without licences, fire clearances or in myriad violations of building norms?

The difficulty lies elsewhere. It lies in political pressure and vote-bank calculations and in the thriving informal economies that governments are reluctant to confront and where urban laws and regulations are routinely violated. But, most importantly, it lies in corruption.

Could the fire in Lucknow have been averted? Yes. In 2016, a notice for demolition was given but within two months was withdrawn. It was clearly a political decision. The property stood out as a symbol of political patronage under benign oversight of officials, right in the midst of a prominent locality of the capital. This sends out a message to the lower officials, the enforcers, who then entrench a system of their own beneficiaries, overlooking various violations for monetary benefits.

The Special Investigation Team (SIT) formed to investigate the fire comprised two senior officers, from the IAS and the IPS from the State of Uttar Pradesh, with the report to be submitted to another IAS officer of the government. The head of Lucknow land development Authority is also an IAS officer. In such a situation, can the inquiry yield anything purposeful. If a calamity of this kind results only in a conversation between a closed loop of bureaucrats, can there ever be any meaningful reform? No. But it was certainly possible if the Minister of Urban Development and the head of the capital land development authority were indicted for this tragedy.

This pattern is visible across the country. In Noida, a young professional lost his life after falling into a waterlogged, poorly protected urban hazard. In Indore, celebrated nationally for cleanliness, deaths linked to contaminated water supply raise disturbing questions about basic civic safeguards. Bengaluru, India's technology capital, repeatedly grinds to a halt after heavy rains. Mumbai, India's financial capital, continues to struggle with flooding despite decades of investment and repeated expert recommendations.

A common thread

Different cities. Different governments. Different political parties, but the same outcome. The real concern is the absence of accountability and governance deficit. What happened after Delhi's basement coaching centre tragedy? Arrests were made. Committees were constituted. Headlines were generated. Yet, illegal and unsafe basement operations continue to flourish in many cities.

How many inquiry reports have fundamentally Real Creator IAS Edition <https://whatsapp.com/channel/0029Van2VRb6RGJOKH6oBd0F>

Iran's Afghan balancing act amid regional upheaval

The funeral proceedings of Iran's late Supreme Leader, Ayatollah Ali Khamenei, that stretched over a week amid a spiralling war and significant internal turmoil at the seat of power for Shiism, saw multiple personalities visit Tehran. Almost unnoticed, however, was the presence of delegations from both the Taliban and the opposition Northern Alliance. The two have been fighting each other, in various iterations, over Afghanistan since the 1990s.

Complex equations

The presence of the Taliban's Deputy Prime Minister for Economic Affairs Mullah Abdul Ghani Baradar along with Taliban Foreign Minister Amir Khan Muttaqi on the one hand and the Northern Alliance's Ahmed Massoud, son of the group's founder Ahmed Shah Massoud on the other, highlighted the delicate game of geopolitics that continues to persist on Tehran's eastern front. While Iran is the one country which has built the strongest influence with Kabul since the collapse of the government of President Ashraf Ghani (August 2021), it still does not officially recognise the Taliban government. This is hardly surprising, considering that until the 1990s, Iran, along with India, Russia, Tajikistan and other neighbouring and foreign states, supported the Northern Alliance.

The chaotic withdrawal of the United States from Afghanistan, in August 2021, two decades after a post-9/11 war launched against al Qaeda was a critical moment in Tehran. The consistent and massive deployment of western military power on its borders was a perpetual nightmare that had to be factored into its calculations. Pakistan's support for and incubation of the Afghan Taliban, while simultaneously backing the U.S.-led 'war on terror', created a sinkhole of competing interests, where the Venn diagram of who was supporting whom became so



Kabir Taneja

Executive Director of the Observer Research Foundation Middle East

The events of 2021 on Iran's eastern front continue to influence Tehran's choices amid the war in 2026

convoluted that foreign powers often ceded the upper hand to regional players. The fact that al Qaeda founder Osama Bin Laden was eventually found in Abbottabad, Pakistan (May 2011), in a large house – and not a cave in the infamous Tora Bora – was not a coincidence.

The Afghan chessboard

The Iranian viewpoint on the Taliban and the Afghan landscape changed significantly after 9/11. While Tehran remains sceptical of the Taliban and the future of its rule to this day, it simultaneously recognises that an insurgency-turned-government will always carry a question mark over its long-term stability. The ideological and tribal fissures that persist also require micromanagement, which means creating enemies along volatile borders is not in anyone's long-term interests.

Following 2021, the Taliban was in search of both power and patronage. Iran could offer some of the power, but only a limited amount of the patronage. The calculation behind this was to free up a major front from as much conflict as possible. The Northern Alliance, largely concentrated in the mountainous northern province of Panjshir, was both weak and disorganised, with infighting having hollowed out any possibility of cohesion and structure. In fact, since February, as clouds of war gathered, the Taliban reiterated that it would support Iran should the country come under attack. Zabihullah Mujahid, a spokesman close to Taliban emir Hibatullah Akhundzada, said in an interview with Iranian state radio that they would support Iran if need be. The nature and extent of such support, of course, remain subjects of debate. Diplomatic support from Kabul has been robust over the past year, including access to the country's civilian airports.

But the Iranians hosting Masood and the Northern Alliance delegation in Tehran shows Real Creator IAS Edition <https://t.me/+8B98m5PQCF84MmQ9>

altered urban governance? How many officials have faced meaningful consequences years after disasters? How many systemic reforms have followed repeated tragedies? India has actually become adept at managing outrage and far less effective in preventing a recurrence of man-made tragedies.

At the heart of the problem lies a governance structure that nobody wishes to discuss honestly. For over three decades, since the 74th Constitutional Amendment, India has spoken of empowering urban local bodies. Yet, most city governments remain weak. Every Chief Minister is the de facto mayor for all cities in his/her State and municipal corporations have responsibility without authority. Elected representatives have visibility without power. Important functions remain scattered across development authorities, municipal corporations, public works departments, water boards, transport agencies and numerous specialised bodies.

A flooded road belongs to one agency, a drain to another, land to a third and enforcement to a fourth. Citizens, meanwhile, simply see government. This fragmentation has created a dangerous accountability vacuum.

Fix governance first

The answer therefore is not another scheme. Indian cities are already overflowing with schemes, missions, projects and programmes. Every few years a new initiative comes up with a new acronym and fresh funding. The problem is not the absence of schemes, but the absence of governance. A number of well-meaning schemes lie buried under corruption and mismanagement. Cities require empowered local institutions, professional urban management, clear accountability and fearless enforcement. Technology must become an instrument of compliance rather than a showcase of modernisation. Most importantly, governments must find the political courage to dismantle entrenched systems of tolerated illegality. Officers, the enforcers, look away fearing a clash with political vested interests.

The victims of Lucknow and Delhi fires did not die because India lacks fire safety laws. They died despite those laws. That is the distinction policymakers must understand. Urban governance is ultimately measured not by the number of projects inaugurated, smart-city dashboards installed or schemes announced, but by the number of tragedies prevented. The real test of governance is whether an ordinary citizen can work, live, study, shop or sleep in a building without fear of dying because somebody chose to ignore the rules.

Will this tragedy become yet another file, another enquiry and another forgotten headline? Or will it finally compel us to confront the uncomfortable truth that India's cities are not merely growing beyond their capacity but are increasingly failing the very citizens they were meant to serve?

that, despite the war in West Asia, Iran is not willing to put all its eggs in one basket when it comes to Afghanistan. The country, and its intricacies, remain a problem that needs strategic management. The fact that the Taliban is still prioritising solidifying its own power and structure, especially between Kabul, the political capital, and Kandahar, the ideological one, highlights that homogeneously supporting the group is still not seen as being wise. For Tehran, this geography remains critical. For example, Quds Force, the powerful Islamic Revolutionary Guard Corps' (IRGC) elite external operations branch, has been run by Esmail Qaani since the assassination of Qasem Soleimani in 2020 by the U.S. Qaani, is known to be a Khorasan hand (Iran's north/eastern neighbours such as Afghanistan, Turkmenistan, among others). Qaani's operational history goes back to the Taliban versus Northern Alliance era of the 1990s.

Ties with Pakistan

The war currently engulfing West Asia is expected to remain a constant for at least a few months to come. Pakistan's role as a mediator between Tehran and Washington DC, has given a new lease of 'brotherhood' between the two. Nonetheless, their aims are divergent. For Pakistan, the objective is to get back into the good books of both the U.S. and Gulf partners (Islamabad now has troops stationed in Saudi Arabia). For Iran, it is about reaching out to the U.S. through a neighbour it knows, if not trusts, better than most. The Iran-Pakistan bilateral relationship is incidental to everything else.

Increasingly, no binaries exist in international diplomacy. Neither do brotherhoods. Every hug is exchanged with one eye always open. These realities predate contemporary politics in South Asia and West Asia, long before the disintegration of western power began to take the shape we are witnessing today.

reform. His vision can help the task force prepare India's education system for the demands of a rapidly evolving knowledge economy. However, the committee's success will depend on more than recommendations. The government must ensure transparent

implementation, clear timelines, measurable outcomes, and regular public accountability to restore trust among millions of aspiring students.

M. Jeyaram,
Sholavandan, Tamil Nadu

Letters emailed to letters@thehindu.co.in must carry the postal address.

Co-existing with tigers outside reserves

India's tiger conservation story is widely regarded as one of the world's most extraordinary wildlife recoveries – a species brought back from near extinction through sustained political commitment, scientific management, and decades of on-ground protection. Since the launch of Project Tiger in 1973, the country's network of protected areas has expanded from nine reserves covering 18,278 sq km to 58 reserves spanning 84,488 sq km, accounting for nearly 2.6% of India's landmass. India's tiger population has risen from 1,411 in 2006 to 3,682 in 2022, firmly establishing the country as home to over 70% of the world's wild tigers. This success has now created a new conservation frontier – the growing proportion of tigers living outside protected areas.

Although national datasets do not conclusively link rising tiger numbers with increasing human-tiger conflict, forest departments across several landscapes report a steady escalation in such incidents. As territorial carnivores require extensive home ranges, tigers disperse naturally when core habitats reach saturation. Consequently, more tigers are moving beyond protected boundaries into human-dominated fringes. According to the National Tiger Conservation Authority, 35-40% of India's tiger population now lives outside designated Tiger Reserves. This reality has prompted the Ministry of Environment, Forest and Climate Change to launch the Tigers Outside Tiger Reserves (TOTR) initiative.

Beyond protected boundaries
The growing tiger population reflects healthy breeding groups, functional habitats, and well-connected forest corridors. However, when tigers move beyond protected areas into landscapes interwoven with villages, farms, roads and other human infrastructure, interactions



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The objective of the Tigers Outside Tiger Reserves initiative is to establish a scientifically grounded, landscape-based framework for conserving tigers outside protected areas while safeguarding human lives

Real Creator IAS Edition <https://t.me/+8B98m5PQCF84MmQ9> with people become inevitable, leading to human fatalities, livestock depredation, accidental encounters, prolonged rescue operations, and heightened public anxiety. Each incident carries ecological, social, and political consequences, placing enormous pressure on forest departments and district administrations.

The objective of the TOTR is to establish a scientifically grounded, landscape-based framework for conserving tigers outside protected areas while safeguarding human lives and livelihoods. Rather than responding to conflict only after it occurs, the initiative seeks to shift the approach from reactive crisis management to proactive, science-driven governance built on technology, preparedness, and community participation.

The TOTR is being launched as a targeted pilot rather than a nationwide rollout, recognising that long-term policy must be anchored in evidence generated under real field conditions.

The All-India Tiger Estimation (2022) recorded tiger presence across 212 forest divisions. Based on this assessment, 40 forest divisions across nine States have been selected for the first phase of the TOTR implementation. The participating States include Uttarakhand, Uttar Pradesh, Rajasthan, Madhya Pradesh, Maharashtra, Karnataka, Tamil Nadu, Telangana and Assam.

The TOTR rests on two complementary pillars. The first focuses on reducing human-tiger conflict and strengthening field protection. This includes upgrading communication systems, deploying rapid response teams, improving rescue infrastructure, and ensuring coordinated action during emergencies. The second pillar emphasises long-term coexistence. Conservation outside protected areas cannot succeed without the trust and participation of local communities. Awareness programmes, community engagement, timely compensation

and treating villagers as partners are central to the initiative. Tigers and people now co-occur across vast shared landscapes, making structured coexistence essential for long-term stability.

Among these, streamlined and timely compensation mechanisms are critical. Although States have their own frameworks, delays often erode public trust and fuel resentment. States must simplify procedures and invest in sustained outreach to build confidence among rural families living alongside tigers.

The role of States

Participating States will also need to invest strategically in both technology and institutional capacity. The programme rightly emphasises the use of modern conservation tools such as camera traps, GPS-enabled monitoring systems, drones and AI to strengthen surveillance, improve early warning systems and enable evidence-based decision-making. However, technology alone cannot resolve human-tiger conflict. Its effectiveness will ultimately depend on the strength of the institutions that support it. Building public confidence requires well-trained forest staff, veterinarians, and rescue teams capable of responding rapidly in conflict situations.

The TOTR underscores a broader national imperative: strengthening the governance of shared landscapes where ecological processes and human livelihoods intersect daily. The initiative signals a shift from viewing tiger conservation solely through the lens of protected areas to recognising the wider mosaic of reserve forests and other lands that now support dispersing tigers.

If executed with the same determination that made Project Tiger a global benchmark, the TOTR could become India's defining conservation initiative of the century proving that people and large carnivores can share space safely.

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Need for moderation in public speech

Tamil Nadu's political arena has become a theatre of vitriolic discourse

STATE OF PLAY

M.S. Shanmugam

Mark Twain once said, “the difference between the almost right word and the right word is really a large matter.”

In recent times, public discourse in Tamil Nadu's political arena has come under scrutiny. Concerns are being raised across sections of society about the tone, content, and quality of speeches delivered by leaders from both the ruling and Opposition parties. Allegations, counter-allegations, legal actions, agitated debates on television channels and newspapers have become frequent, indicating not merely isolated incidents, but a worrying trend.

Political speech is not just a tool for mobilisation; it is a reflection of democratic culture. Furthermore, it is one of the most basic tools and features of democracy. It is how parties take their policies and views to the people. However, when language descends into personal attacks, provocation, or sensationalism, it sets a precedent. And a bad one at that.

History teaches us that while such precedents are easy to establish, they are exceedingly difficult to reverse.

Global precedents

The experience of the United States during the McCarthy era in the 1950s offers a telling lesson. Senator Joseph McCarthy's speeches, marked by sweeping allegations and dramatic accusations, created a climate of fear and mistrust. Careers were ruined, institutions were strained, and public discourse suffered.



It took a moment of collective introspection – captured in the famous question, “Have you no sense of decency, sir?” – to begin restoring balance. The damage, however, lingered far beyond that moment.

Similarly, in Europe, the final years of the Weimar Republic saw a steady decline in the quality of political speech. Increasingly harsh and polarising rhetoric eroded mutual respect among political actors and weakened democratic norms. What began as verbal aggression eventually contributed to a breakdown of stability itself.

The lesson was clear: words, when used unchecked, can shape outcomes far beyond immediate political gains.

Leaders shape discourse

In a mature democracy, citizens expect more from their leaders. They look for clarity of vision rather than clever invective; for solutions rather than slogans; and for dignity even in disagreement.

Political speech must inform, inspire, and unify – not inflame or divide. The divisive and exclusive, as opposed to inclusive, trends in speeches are causing deep concerns at the local as well as the global level.

Moderation in speech is

not a sign of weakness; it is a mark of strength and responsibility. It reflects confidence in one's ideas and respect for the audience. When there is solid substance, the words spoken become the natural foundation on which to reach the people.

Leaders at all levels set the tone for public behaviour. When they uphold dignity, society follows. When they abandon it, the consequences ripple outward to the last man.

At this juncture, there is an opportunity for all stakeholders – across party lines – to pause and reflect. Reaffirming norms of respectful discourse, setting internal standards for communication, and prioritising public interest over momentary applause can help restore balance. Media needs to play a crucial role by not promoting or repeating sensational utterances for increasing their viewership.

For the next generation

Democracy thrives not merely on the freedom of speech, but on the wisdom with which that freedom is exercised. The younger generation, the future of the country, must be inspired by principled political discourse. When leaders speak with integrity and purpose, they not only shape public opinion and culture but also motivate young citizens to strive for excellence and grow into worthy contributors to the nation.

The need of the hour therefore is, not louder voices, but moderated ones – grounded in dignity, guided by responsibility, and committed to the larger good.

The author is a former IAS officer of the Tamil Nadu cadre.

Over 70% of police back immunity for using force

Official data on injuries sustained during police operations contradict numbers presented in news coverage and reports

DATA POINT

Devvyanshi Bihani
Nitika Francis
Gandla Sneha

The police response to the Cockroach Janta Party's (CJP) “Chalo Sansad” march earlier this week has once again put the spotlight on the powers of the police. As videos showing tear gas, pellet guns, and lathi charges circulated widely, questions resurfaced over when force may be used, the safeguards governing arrests, and the balance between maintaining public order and exercising civil liberties. Under the Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita (BNSS), force may be used to disperse an unlawful assembly only after an order to disperse is disobeyed, while the National Human Rights Commission's Manual on Human Rights for Police Officers requires officers to rely on persuasion, advice and warning, using only minimum force when force becomes unavoidable. Yet the Status of Policing in India Report 2025, which surveyed 8,276 police personnel across 17 States and UTs, suggests that many in the police favour broader coercive powers.

One of the most striking findings was that more than 70% of respondents agreed that police should be allowed to use force without fear of punishment in order to properly discharge their responsibilities (**Chart 1**). Nearly as many (69%) believed that the police should be allowed to arrest and detain suspected criminals without any court investigation, revealing a tendency to exercise power arbitrarily (**Chart 2**).

Further, more than half of the respondents (55%) considered it either “very” or “somewhat” important for the police to use “tough methods” to create fear among the public (**Chart 3**). Around two-thirds said that public pressure influences the police to

deal with suspected criminals with a “heavy hand”. Nearly half of the respondents (48%) said that more preventive arrests of “anti-social elements” would be very useful in reducing crime (**Table 1**).

The survey's findings also raise questions about the perceptions of due process after arrest. Only 41% of police personnel said that statutory arrest procedures are always followed. These include informing the arrested person of the grounds of arrest, preparing arrest and inspection memos, notifying family members, ensuring a medical examination, and informing the accused of the right to contact a lawyer. One in five believed private consultation of the arrested with their lawyers should never be permitted. These findings offer a glimpse into institutional attitudes, their misalignment with legal frameworks, and the need for sensitising police on use of force.

The report notes that “India's otherwise robust crime data begins to waver when it comes to incidents of torture or deaths in custody” and that the available data is “inaccurate and inconsistent”. The past few editions of the National Crime Record Bureau's (NCRB) ‘Crime in India’ report have shown a declining number of civilians injured during police operations despite the occurrence of many widely reported incidents.

For instance, the NCRB says only 76 civilians were injured during police operations in India in 2020 despite the beginning of the year witnessing widespread protests against the Citizenship Amendment Act, particularly in north-east Delhi. A report by the UN High Commissioner for Human Rights states that over 200 were injured in Delhi alone. Another case of underreporting was in 2024, when only two civilians were injured during police operations, as per the NCRB. The ‘Dilli Chalo’ protests organised by farmers in that year resulted in police resorting to using force on many occasions (**Chart 4**).



Chart 1: “To properly fulfil their responsibilities, police should be allowed to use force without any fear of punishment” (Values in %)

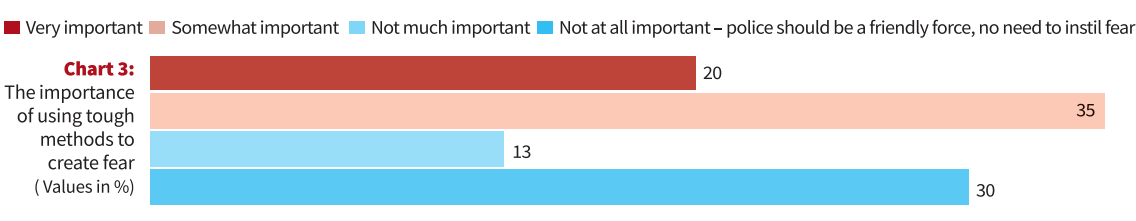
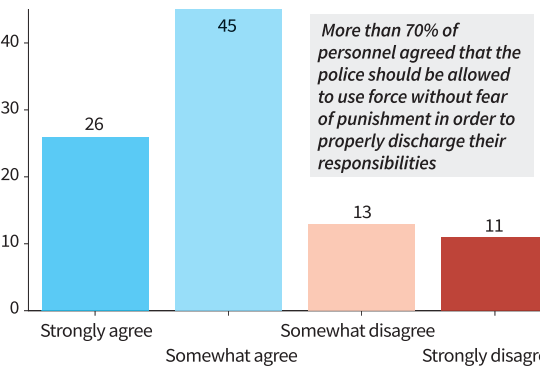


Table 1: Police personnel's views on the usefulness of various crime-control measures (Values in %)

Measures for crime control	Very useful	Somewhat useful	Not much useful	Not at all useful
Increasing the presence of beat police and /or patrolling or the number of police stations/chowkis	64	25	7	2
Recruiting more women into the police	58	26	10	5
More preventive arrests of “anti-social elements”	48	36	10	5
Forming special squads that can detain people indefinitely	43	28	15	12

Chart 4: Civilians injured during riots due to police firing and lathi charge in India as per NCRB

Source: The Status of Policing in India Report 2025 is the sixth report in the Status of Policing in India (SPIR) series brought out by Common Cause and the Lokniti programme of the Centre for the Study of Developing Societies

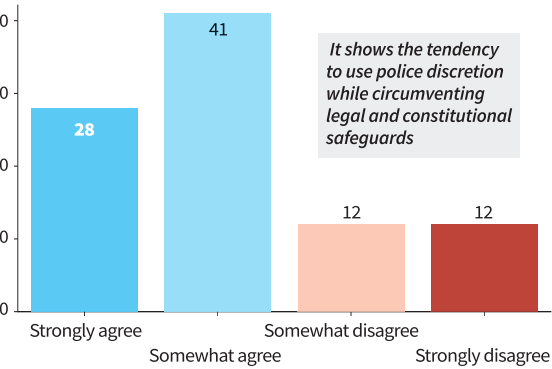
(Gandla Sneha is intern with The Hindu's Data Team)

The police beat

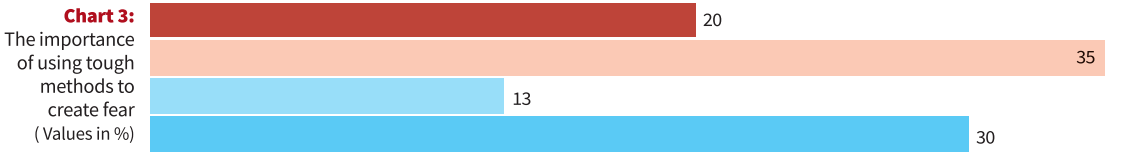
The Status of Policing in India 2025 report offers glimpses into the institutional attitude of the police in the country and the need for reforms. The charts below show the responses of the police personnel surveyed for the report for the questions mentioned in the respective charts

Brutality of power: Police personnel carry out a lathi charge on protesters during the “Chalo Sansad” march from Jantar Mantar to Parliament against the NEET paper leak, in New Delhi on July 20.

Chart 2: “Should the police be allowed to arrest and detain suspects without court investigation?” (Values in %)

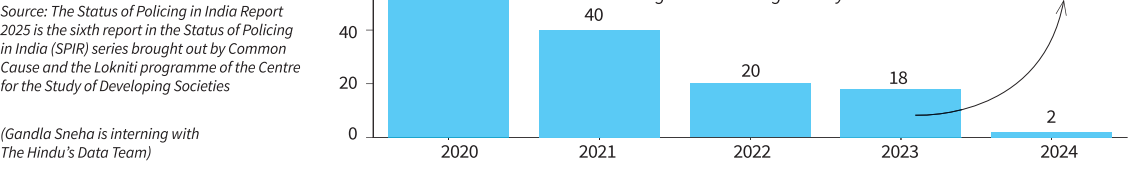


Very important Somewhat important Not much important Not at all important – police should be a friendly force, no need to instil fear



Police personnel who strongly support legitimate measures are also the most likely to support the use of coercive actions, This reveals the inconsistencies in police perceptions

Reports from PTI states that more than 30 students, mostly women, were injured in Manipur's Imphal Valley as the police fired tear gas shells and baton-charged a crowd protesting against the killing of two youths



FROM THE ARCHIVES

The Hindu.

FIFTY YEARS AGO JULY 29, 1976

The King comes to the park

Madras, July 28: The Madras Snake Park, Guindy, has a new addition – a King Cobra. It was caught in the North Andamans rain forest on June 15 by Mr. Romulus Whitaker, Honorary Director of the Park. Since coming to Madras on July 1, it has been housed in a special enclosure, where its natural habitat is simulated.

A King Cobra brought to the Snake Park from Thailand died after seven months. Another from Karnataka also did not survive for long. Hence efforts are being made to air condition the enclosure. Visitors can see it moving in the cooler hours of the day.

According to Mr. Whitaker, the King Cobra is found only in certain rain forests and in extreme estuarine mangrove swarms of the Sunderbans (Bengal), the Bhitarkanika sanctuary on the Orissa coast, and the Western Ghats.

Twelve to 15 inches long when hatched, King cobras can grow to a maximum length of 19 feet, with a girth of about five inches. The female lays about 20 eggs at a time, and the hatching takes about two months. (The snake brought to Madras is a female).

The King Cobra is not a true cobra, though it is also poisonous. It is not of the same genus as the common cobra.

A HUNDRED YEARS AGO JULY 29, 1926

The Czar's fortune

A special cable to “The Times of India” from London, dated July 26th states:—

A former attache at the Czar's court informs certain Italian newspapers that Czar Nicholas deposited a fortune in London on the outbreak of war of which, despite withdrawals to alleviate Russian distress, £12,000,000 plus interest remains.

The Czar's surviving relations desire King George or ex-King Manuel to arbitrate its disposal but cannot legally prove the Czar is dead.

“The Daily News” says inquiries in Russian and British Diplomatic circles do not confirm or deny the report. Although the sum may be exaggerated it must be remembered that the Kaiser before abdication saved half a million sterling yearly. The Soviet Embassy is sceptical. They admit large sums of Czarist money exist in London. General Koltchak sent to London £3,000,000 of Russian State funds when he captured Kazan.

THE HINDU

44.73 crore. More than 44.73 crore Ayushman cards have been created under the Ayushman Bharat-Pradhan Mantri Jan Arogya Yojana (AB-PMJAY), while over 12.69 crore hospital admissions worth ₹1.92 lakh crore have been authorised under the scheme, the Parliament was told on Tuesday. PTI

COMPILED BY THE HINDU DATA TEAM

CM
YK

KEYWORD

Beyond national interest: role of ethics and emotions in world politics

History offers numerous examples of ethics shaping international politics. Foreign policy is not merely an exercise in strategic calculation; it is also shaped by moral perceptions and collective emotions, as illustrated by the change in public perception towards the Israel-Palestine conflict.

Dhananjay Tripathi

The language of world politics has become remarkably predictable. Every military strike, diplomatic initiative, economic sanction, or strategic partnership is justified in the name of national interest. Television debates and commentaries have a common vocabulary – power, deterrence, balance of power, strategic autonomy, and security. It almost appears as though International Relations has become an emotionless discipline, focused on power concentration, where morality and ethics have little place. Yet the defining geopolitical crises of recent years tell a very different story.

Influence of Western traditions International Relations, both as an academic discipline and as a practice of diplomacy, has been largely shaped by Western intellectual traditions, with much of academic research originating in the United States of America. No wonder, famous IR scholar, Stanley Hoffman, in his article, argued that IR is an American Social Science. It is difficult to refute Hoffman’s argument because initially the modern international order emerged when European powers dominated much of the world, leaving the Global South with little role in designing the institutions, norms, and rules that continue to govern global politics. However, the discipline itself acquired its modern identity after the Second World War, with the U.S. based scholar, Hans Morgenthau’s Realism becoming the dominant framework for understanding international affairs. Realism portrays the international system as anarchic and argues that states, in the absence of a central authority, are compelled to pursue their national interests. Although the theory is far more nuanced than its popular interpretation suggests, public discourse has reduced it to two defining ideas—anarchy and national interest. Over time, Realism travelled from classrooms to newsrooms, becoming the default language through which foreign policy is interpreted.

There is much to appreciate in the Realist tradition. It reminds us that power, military capability, and strategic calculations remain central to international politics. However, the dominance of Realism has also encouraged the belief that foreign policy is little more than a rational pursuit of national interest. Ethical considerations are often dismissed as idealistic, while emotions are treated as irrational distractions. Yet certain recent scholarships in International Relations have increasingly challenged this assumption. Scholars such as Neta Crawford have argued that emotions are not the opposite of rationality; rather, they are integral to political judgment. Fear, grief, anger, humiliation, empathy, and pride actively shape how leaders interpret threats, define interests, and respond to crises. Foreign policy, therefore, is not merely an exercise in cold strategic calculation, but also a product of moral perceptions and collective emotions. This dynamic is encapsulated by scholar Brent Sasley, who notes that while state leaders make



Moral reckoning: A protest held in solidarity with Palestine, condemning Israel’s actions against Gaza, in Bengaluru on September 26, 2025. ALLEN EGENUSE J.

formal decisions as members of a group, “they do so within a particular (social) context and on that (social) basis”.

Question of political legitimacy The recent U.S.-Iran conflict illustrates this point. Much of the strategic analysis focused on military capabilities, damage assessments, and the future balance of power in West Asia. Comparatively little attention was paid to the emotional and ethical consequences of the conflict. The assassination of Ayatollah Ali Khamenei, who was not only Iran’s Supreme Leader but also one of the most influential religious figures in the Shia world, produced consequences that extended far beyond military calculations. Rather than weakening the Iranian state, his death generated an extraordinary wave of national solidarity. A society that had appeared politically divided only months earlier united around a shared sense of loss, nationalism, and religious identity. Crawford’s observation that grief and the desire for revenge continue to shape political behaviour long after the battlefield has fallen silent is particularly relevant in this context. Military planners may calculate strategic gains, but societies often respond through memory, identity, and emotion. Therefore, it is important to note that foreign policy must not be judged solely by the actions of a government, but also by how those actions shape and influence global public opinion. The debate surrounding the assassination largely focused on how Washington would engage with a post-Khamenei Iran. Far less attention was devoted to the ethical questions raised by such an operation and its implications for America’s moral standing.

The changing international perception of Israel offers another important example. Following the Hamas attacks of October 2023, Israel received widespread sympathy and support across much of the world. Most governments affirmed Israel’s right to defend itself. However, as the humanitarian crisis in Gaza deepened, due to mindless aggression shown by the

Israeli army, public opinion began to shift. Large demonstrations across Europe and North America reflected growing concerns over civilian suffering and questioned the proportionality of Israel’s military response. In this, governments and societies increasingly spoke in different voices. While many governments continued to emphasise security considerations, public opinion became increasingly influenced by humanitarian concerns. Thus, while military superiority can alter realities on the battlefield, it cannot prevent the erosion of moral legitimacy.

Ethical concerns over globalisation History offers numerous examples of ethics shaping international politics. Throughout the Cold War, the U.S. consistently presented itself as the defender of democracy, human rights, and individual liberty while portraying Soviet communism as an authoritarian system hostile to political freedom. The post-war liberal international order derived much of its legitimacy not merely from military and economic strength but also from its claim to uphold universal values. Even globalisation was promoted as a project that would bring societies closer together through greater interdependence and cooperation. Although globalisation generated unprecedented economic growth, it failed to bridge the structural inequalities between the Global North and the Global South, leading many to question whether the liberal international order had fulfilled its ethical promises.

The position of Global South Historically, the Global South has been among the most vocal in injecting moral considerations into international politics. The Non-Aligned Movement (NAM) was not merely a strategy to avoid Cold War rivalries; it represented a normative vision of sovereign equality and a collective call for a more just world order. Contemporary India continues to invoke similar ideas through its emphasis on the Global South and the civilisational

philosophy of ‘*Vasudhaiva Kutumbakam*’—the world is one family. Notably, India’s international standing has historically rested not only on its growing economic and strategic capabilities but also on its democratic institutions, pluralism, and anti-colonial legacy. During the Bangladesh Liberation War of 1971, for instance, international public opinion gradually shifted in India’s favour after the humanitarian catastrophe in East Pakistan became widely known. More recently, India’s consistent opposition to cross-border terrorism has enjoyed broad international support because it resonates with widely accepted ethical norms.

This moral capital, however, cannot be taken for granted; it must be continuously reinforced through consistent foreign policy choices. For instance, India’s relatively restrained response to recent developments in West Asia has generated debate over whether its pursuit of strategic autonomy truly aligns with the ethical principles it frequently projects. Ultimately, India’s international standing is built on more than just its market size. It is widely applauded as a vibrant, multicultural nation where democracy has successfully endured.

In conclusion, it is a mistake to interpret International Relations merely as the study of the redistribution of power; it is equally crucial to understand how that power is evaluated. In a world defined by Artificial Intelligence, digital media, transnational activism, and instantaneous communication, wars are no longer judged solely by governments or strategic analysts. Instead, real-time images of civilian suffering, humanitarian crises, and political violence actively shape international narratives as they unfold. While Realism remains highly relevant for explaining why states pursue power and security, achieving a comprehensive and nuanced understanding of world politics requires us to examine how societies accept, reject, or morally evaluate that power. *(Dhananjay Tripathi teaches International Relations at the South Asian University, New Delhi.)*



FROM THE ARCHIVES

Know your English

S. Upendran

What is the meaning and the origin of the idiom “grinning like a Cheshire cat”? (D. Geetham, Madurai)

When you say that someone is “grinning like a Cheshire cat”, it means that he/she has a broad smile on his/her face.

Here are a few examples:
Divya obviously knows something. She has been walking around all morning grinning like a Cheshire cat.

When Leya walked in grinning like a Cheshire cat, I knew that she had come first in her class.

Cheshire is the name of a county in England. Before you jump to any conclusions, let me assure you that the cats from this county aren’t famous for their grins! The place, however, was famous for its cheese.

The cheese makers from this place used to draw the figure of a smiling cat on a special type of cheese. People who bought this type of cheese saw the face of a cat with a broad smile.

So the cat in the idiom “grin like a Cheshire cat” is not a real cat, but the figure that was found on cheese. Although the idiom has been around for several centuries, it was the author of “Alice in Wonderland”, Lewis Carroll, who made it famous.

In the novel, Alice runs into a large cat with a big smile. When Alice asks why he is grinning, the Duchess replies, “It’s a Cheshire cat and that’s why.” In the story, the cat begins to disappear slowly; it is the tail that disappears first and the smile fades last.

So at one point all that Alice sees is the face with a big smile.

What is the meaning of “Gandhi’s revenge”? (P. Balasubramanian, Chennai)

Ever heard the expression “Montezuma’s revenge”? It means diarrhoea. Tourists who went to Mexico invariably ended up with an upset stomach – they attributed this to the spicy food and also the water.

Example:
Satish had a little touch of Montezuma’s revenge on the second day.

You can now probably guess what “Gandhi’s revenge” means. It’s an attack of dysentery that some people experience after eating spicy Indian food. Of course, one doesn’t have to visit India to experience “Gandhi’s revenge”; you can suffer the consequences after eating in any of the restaurants abroad.

My friend claims that the word “latrinogram” exists. Is it true? (P. Harish, Hyderabad)

We have all come across the words “telegram”, “phonogram”. But “latrinogram”? Sounds ridiculous, doesn’t it? But your friend is right, the word “latrinogram” does exist.

As you have probably guessed, it consists of two words – “latrine” and “gram”.

A “phonogram” is a message that you receive over the phone. So, what do you think a “latrinogram” is? Yes, it’s a message that you receive in the latrine! In this case, it is a rumour which originates in the latrines of offices – working people have a tendency to exchange a lot of information (gossip!) in bathrooms.

Examples:
There was a latrinogram yesterday about the boss being asked to resign.

Sudha is marrying Sudhir! No way! That’s just another latrinogram.
Published in The Hindu on June 5, 2001

THE DAILY QUIZ

Some significant events occurred on July 29. Here is a quiz on observances, birthdays and everything else that happened on this day

K. Abhinava

QUESTION 1
This U.S. President signed a legislation to create NASA after the Soviet Union launched Sputnik 1. Name the President and the year when the legislation was created.

QUESTION 2
This Swedish Economist, who was born on this day, received the Noble Peace Prize in 1961. He also served as the secretary-general of the UN. Identify the economist.

QUESTION 3
At an international summit

held in 2010 it was decided that July 29 would be marked as International Tiger Day. Did India take part in the Summit and name the host country.

QUESTION 4
The first part of this three-part fantasy novel series was published on this day in 1954. The series was first revised and republished in 1965. Identify the title of the first book.

QUESTION 5
The wedding of this royal couple on this day was watched by over 700 million people on television. It was broadcast in 74 countries. Identify the couple.



Visual question: A part of the wreckage of the Malaysian Airlines flight MH370 was found on the shore of Réunion Island in the Indian Ocean on July 29, 2015. What is the part called? AFP

Questions and answers to the previous day’s daily quiz: 1. Three properties from India were the first to be given UNESCO World Heritage Site status in 1983. **Ans: Ajanta Caves, Ellora Caves, the Agra Fort**
2. Unique feature of the Khangchendzonga National Park inscribed to the list. **Ans: It is the only one in the Mixed category**
3. The inscribed property across Tamil Nadu, West Bengal and Himachal Pradesh. **Ans: The Mountain Railways of India (Nilgiri Mountain Railway, Darjeeling Himalayan Railway and Kalka Shimla Railway)**
4. Name the two sites that were at different times part of ‘World Heritage in Danger’ list. **Ans: Manas Wildlife Sanctuary and the monuments at Hampi**
5. This site is transnational being shared with six other countries. **Ans: The Architectural Work of Le Corbusier**
6. Inscribed in 2003, this site exhibits the earliest traces of human life in India. **Ans: Rock Shelters of Bhimbetka, Madhya Pradesh**
7. The Indian currency notes featuring the Konark Sun Temple and the Sanchi Stupa. **Ans: Rs. 10 and Rs. 200 respectively**
Visual: Name this WHS and the State in which it is located. **Ans: Rani ki Vav, Gujarat**
Correction: In Question 2 of the quiz featured yesterday, the year should have been 2016 and not 2014 as published. The error is regretted.
Early birds: Prem Nath Tiwari| Tamal Biswas| Sunil Madhavan |Sudhir Thapa | Sitaram Saharay

Paper leak Bill a milestone, says govt.; Opposition calls it ‘cosmetic exercise’

Minister says amendment shows PM’s resolve not to compromise the future of children; Congress leader asks why the government is amending a law it had hailed as ‘historic’ just two years ago; SP member slams the govt. over police action

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

The Treasury and Opposition benches sparred in the Lok Sabha on Tuesday as the House took up the Public Examinations (Prevention of Unfair Means) Amendment Bill, 2026, with the Opposition describing it as an “admission of failure”.

The Bill seeks to strengthen the 2024 anti-paper leak law with stricter punishment of up to 10-year imprisonment and a fine of up to ₹50 lakh.

Initiating the discussion on the Bill, Union Minister Jitendra Singh said the amendment showed Prime Minister Narendra Modi’s resolve not to compromise the future of children. The government described it as a “milestone” legislation in the history of Parliament.

“Incidents of paper leaks have taken place in various States ruled by different parties. The anti-paper leak Bill is a reaffirmation of the government’s commitment to safeguard the welfare of



Minister Jitendra Singh speaks in the Lok Sabha during the debate on the Public Examinations Amendment Bill, 2026 on Tuesday. PTI Real Creator IAS Edition <https://t.me/+8B98m5PQCF84MmQ9> to refer investigation of offences under the Act to a Special Task Force constituted for the purpose.

Speedy justice

Mr. Singh said the Bill provided for the establishment of Special Fast Track Courts to deal with offences relating to public examinations.

He said it envisaged completion of investigations within two months and trials within three months from the date of filing of chargesheet. The Bill also empowers the Centre

government was amending a law it had hailed as “historic” just two years ago.

“If that law was so effective, why has the government been forced to bring such major amendments within two years?” Mr. Gogoi asked, calling the Bill a “cosmetic exercise” that reflected the failure of the 2024 law enacted after the earlier NEET-UG controversy.

‘Inability exposed’ He argued that the latest paper leak had exposed the government’s inability to protect the integrity of public examinations and said harsher punishments alone would not end the menace without structural reforms in the education system.

He also questioned the fate of recommendations by a 2024 committee headed by former ISRO Chairman K. Radhakrishnan and sought details of the 47 officials the government claimed to have removed or transferred from the National Testing Agency (NTA).

“Who are these 47 peo-

ple, when the sanctioned strength of the NTA is 34?” Mr. Gogoi asked. He also questioned why the government had so much faith in the NTA chairman.

“Is it because he is associated with a particular Sangh?” he asked.

The Congress leader also alleged that 44 of the 45 accused in the 2024 NEET-UG paper leak case had secured bail.

Samajwadi Party (SP) MP Dimple Yadav lashed out at the government for the police action against protesting students.

Responding to the Opposition, BJP MP Anurag Thakur hit out at Leader of the Opposition Rahul Gandhi for sitting on a dharna outside the Prime Minister’s residence, saying Mr. Gandhi did so because students did not ask him to lead the protests.

Calling the amendment “transformative”, BJP member Bansuri Swaraj accused the Opposition of “selective outrage”, contending that paper leaks had also occurred under the UPA government’s tenure.

Joshi’s appointment is an insult to our students, says Rahul

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

Leader of the Opposition Rahul Gandhi on Tuesday launched a sharp attack on Prime Minister Narendra Modi over the appointment of Pralhad Joshi as Union Education Minister, describing him as a “defender of rapists” and “the most filthy type of man”.

His objections were over Mr. Joshi’s purported remarks after the release of convicts in the Bilkis Bano gang-rape case in 2022.

Speaking to reporters outside Parliament, Mr. Gandhi questioned Mr. Modi’s choice at a time when students across the country were protesting over the NEET paper leak.

Calling Mr. Joshi a “defender of rapists”, he said: “That is the most filthy type of man. There can be no filthier man than somebody who says that rapists need protection. That is the Education Minister of India today.”

“It’s strange. It’s a strange reaction from the

Priyanka, Venugopal seek accountability for police action on NEET protesters

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

Congress general secretary (organisation) K.C. Venugopal and Wayanad MP Priyanka Gandhi Vadra on Tuesday demanded accountability for the police action against students protesting the NEET-UG paper leak, accusing the Centre of responding to a democratic movement with force instead of addressing the concerns of aspirants.

Participating in the debate on the Public Examinations (Prevention of Unfair Means) Amendment Bill, 2026, in the Lok Sabha, Ms. Vadra asked Prime Minister Narendra Modi and Union Home Minister Amit Shah to explain who had authorised the use of force, including pellet guns and assault rifles, against protesting students.

“Were they terrorists?” she asked, saying that every lathi blow had damaged the government’s credibility more than it had injured the students. Recalling her visit to Ram Manohar Lohia Hospital, Ms. Vadra said she had met the family of an injured



Congress MP Priyanka Gandhi Vadra speaks in Lok Sabha during the debate on the amendment to the anti-paper leak Bill. ANI

student and argued that the country’s youth had begun losing faith in a system where dishonesty appeared to matter more than merit. Ms. Vadra alleged that 152 examination papers had leaked over the past decade without a single “paper leak mafia” being punished.

Taking a swipe at the Prime Minister, Ms. Vadra said changing camera angles would not help win over Generation Z. “The Prime Minister needs to change the angle of his heart, not the angle of cameras,” she said.

Mr. Venugopal said those responsible for the attacks on peaceful protesters “must be identified and held accountable”.

Beginning his speech by reading out a note left behind by a NEET candidate who died by suicide, Mr. Venugopal said it reflected the immense pressure faced by students.

Citing National Crime Records Bureau data, he said student suicides had risen from 8,068 in 2014 to 14,488 at present. “This is not a statistic but an emergency,” he said, adding the issue reflected deeper problems in the country’s education system.

He questioned the education model where “coaching has become indispensable, students have to approach courts for justice, protesters face police violence, and degrees no longer guarantee jobs”.

Congress’s remarks on Pralhad Joshi are misleading, says BJP

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

The Bharatiya Janata Party (BJP) on Tuesday termed as “condemnable” and “misleading and unacceptable” the remarks made by Priyanka Gandhi Vadra in the Lok Sabha on the newly appointed Union Education Minister Pralhad Joshi as well as the remarks later made outside the House by the Leader of the Opposition in the Lok Sabha Rahul Gandhi.

Ms. Vadra’s remarks were subsequently expunged by Speaker Om Birla.

Lok Sabha member and BJP’s media cell convener Anil Baluni put out a strong statement on behalf of the party after the remarks were made. “The misleading remarks made today in the Lok Sabha by Congress MP Priyanka Gandhi Vadra regarding Union Education Minister Pralhad Joshi, and the subsequent baseless comments by Leader of the Opposition Rahul Gandhi in support of Pri-

yanka Vadra’s statement, are extremely unfortunate and condemnable. In a healthy democracy, such misleading and unwarranted remarks against a Union Minister on the floor of the House cannot be accepted,” Mr. Baluni said.

The reference made by Ms. Vadra and Mr. Gandhi to a comment by Mr. Joshi in the said matter was “completely incorrect”, he further said.

He said Mr. Joshi had, in fact, not made the remarks pertaining to the case of gang-rape survivor Bilkis Bano. “He had merely commented on the legal process and not on the matter itself,” Mr. Baluni added.

“Before making such statements, Rahul Gandhi and Priyanka Vadra should have read and understood the facts properly. However, distorting statements for political convenience, misleading the country, and levelling baseless allegations has become a habit of the Congress party,” he said in the statement.

Akhilesh says police action at protest akin to Emergency

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

Samajwadi Party (SP) president Akhilesh Yadav on Tuesday compared the police action against students protesting the NEET-UG question paper leak with the Emergency, and claimed the Narendra Modi government had been forced to bend before an unprecedented student movement.

The resignation of former Union Education Minister Dharmendra Pradhan reflected the pressure generated by the student agitation, Mr. Yadav said, participating in the Lok Sabha debate on the Public Examinations (Prevention of Unfair Means) Amendment Bill, 2026.

“By removing one ‘Pradhan’, you effectively saved the ‘Pradhan Mantri,’” the SP leader said.

The police used “lathis with spikes, and electric batons” against students, he said, describing the scenes in Delhi as reminiscent of the Emergency.

DMK reiterates demand to scrap NEET, accuses Centre of ignoring concerns of T.N.

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

The Dravida Munnetra Kazhagam (DMK) on Tuesday renewed its demand for scrapping the National Eligibility-cum-Entrance Test (NEET) in the Lok Sabha, arguing that the proposed amendments to the anti-paper leak law fail to address the “core issue” of the medical entrance examination itself.

During the debate on the Public Examinations (Prevention of Unfair Means) Amendment Bill, 2026, DMK MP Dayanidhi Maran said Tamil Nadu had consistently opposed NEET since its introduction and accused the Centre of ignoring the State’s concerns.

“Enough is enough, ban NEET, abolish NEET. Do not go for ‘One India, One Examination’.” Our strength comes from our diversity,” Mr. Maran said, claiming that 26 students had died by suicide over



DMK MP Dayanidhi Maran speaks in the Lok Sabha during the discussion on the amendment to the anti-paper leak law. PTI

the test in Tamil Nadu.

He claimed NEET disadvantaged first-generation learners and students from State boards while benefiting coaching centres. Citing official figures, he said nearly 22 lakh students appear for NEET every year and around 12 lakh qualify, while there are only about 1.39 lakh undergraduate medical seats.

Questioning the rationale for retaining the examination, Mr. Maran asked whether NEET had improved the quality of doctors, reduced infant mor-

tality, strengthened rural healthcare or addressed the shortage of doctors.

Mr. Maran further alleged that he and NCP (SP) MP Supriya Sule were unable to use WhatsApp broadcast lists for three days because of forwarding restrictions, and criticised what he described as the government’s unequal treatment of social media platforms.

“We are not your enemy,” Ms. Sule said, urging the government to treat the matter with greater seriousness.

‘Unwise to link women’s quota with delimitation’

Nistula Hebbar
NEW DELHI

Bharat Rashtra Samithi leader K.T. Rama Rao has said that the student protests over the leak of NEET question paper was “unique” and an “inflection” point in Indian polity and that the delimitation Bill, if it is tabled in Parliament, should ensure that the southern States maintain their level of representation in the Lok Sabha.

Speaking to *The Hindu* during his visit to Delhi, Mr. Rao said the protests were not just about paper leaks but seemed to have channelled a number of frustrations among the people that needed a trigger point. While anti-incumbency had built up, he conceded that the BJP still had time to recover, but that



K.T. Rama Rao

the lessons for the Opposition were just as dire.

“What you effectively saw was the manifestation of a series of events and not just one isolated incident that resulted in this. They (the BJP) still have time to make amends and maybe win the youngsters back. Also the situation clearly shows that it was not the principle Opposition nor the Opposition bloc as such, that could inspire confidence, and it

Real Creator IAS Edition <https://whatsapp.com/channel/0029Van2VRb6RGJOKH6oBd0F> had to be a students-led, kind of leaderless, rudderless kind of a moment, which just emanated like the Arab Spring had (in 2011). Therefore, it’s unique and it certainly is an inflection point in Indian politics. If you ask me, Prime Minister Modi and his government have never looked as vulnerable as they did in the last 15 days,” he said.

On delimitation, Mr. Rao said it was “unwise” to intertwine women’s reservation and delimitation the way the government had done in April in the Special Session to consider the two Bills. “Women’s reservation can be implemented without linking it or without intertwining it with delimitation. So the fundamental point of Government of India try-

ing to fire the delimitation gun, you know, using a women reservation as a shoulder to lean on is wrong, whereas the women’s reservation Act has already been passed by Parliament,” he said.

“Government of India needs to realise that they are sitting on a powder keg. If they mess with the current ratio, where the southern States as a bloc have 24% representation in Parliament, then most certainly there will be a serious protest erupting in the South,” he said.

He suggested his own formula. “Why is delimitation done in the first place? Because you want increased participation, representative democracy, more decentralisation, etc. So the one way to do it, is basically increase the num-

ber of MLA seats. If they can go ahead and increase the number of MLA seats across the country, there’s 4,000 plus now. That can be enhanced to 6,000. Nobody has a problem. Because then it’s within the geographical confines of one State and when it comes to Parliament, you are not disturbing the *status quo*. The second formula could be one where you actually sit across a table, come to the consensus on how this 24% of South can be maintained as is, so that there is parity and balance,” he said.

“There should not be a penalty for good implementation of population policies, you can’t have a noose around our neck, say that this is good for you (southern States), and stifle our voice,” he said.

**CENTRAL ELECTRICITY REGULATORY COMMISSION**
6th, 7th, & 8th Floor, Tower-B, World Trade Centre, Nauroji Nagar, New Delhi-110029

Petition No. 202/TL/2026

Dated: 27.7.2026

NOTICE UNDER CLAUSE (a) OF SUB-SECTION (5) OF SECTION 15 OF THE ELECTRICITY ACT, 2003

An application under Sections 14, 15 and 79(1)(e) of the Electricity Act, 2003 (the Act) has been made by **Dhule Power Transmission Limited**, Windsor, 1st Floor, Unit No. 101, Kalina, Santacruz (East), Mumbai – 400098, Maharashtra for the grant of a separate RTM Transmission Licence to DPTL for “Implementation of 1 No. of 220 kV line bay at Dhule PS for RE Interconnection (Appl. 2200001584: Adyant Enersol Private Limited: 94 MW)” under the Regulated Tariff Mechanism (hereinafter referred to as “RTM”) mode (hereinafter referred to as “the Project”). The scope of the project for which a transmission licence has been sought is as under:
Implementation of 1 No. 220 kV line bay at Dhule PS for interconnection of M/s Adyant Enersol Pvt. Ltd. (ADEPL) 94 MW RHGS

Sl. No.	Scope of the Transmission Scheme	Item Description	Implementation Timeframe	Implementation Agency
1.	Implementation of 1 No. of 220 kV line bay at Dhule PS for RE Interconnection (Appl. 2200001584: Adyant Enersol Private Limited: 94 MW).	220kV line bay – 1 No. (Sec-I)	18 Months from award to implementing agency	Dhule Power Transmission Limited (subsidiary of IndiGrid 2 Pvt.Ltd.)
Total Estimated Cost:		₹ 5.32 Cr. (May’25 Price Level)		

2. The Central Transmission Utility of India Limited, vide its letter dated 10.4.2026, has recommended for the grant of a transmission licence to the applicant to establish the proposed transmission system.

3. Based on the material available on the record, the Commission vide order dated 26.7.2026 in Petition No. 202/TL/2026, has proposed to issue a transmission licence to the applicant for the establishment of the transmission scheme as noted in para 1 above.

4. A copy of the application, along with its annexures and enclosures, made by the applicant for the grant of an inter-State transmission licence to **Dhule Power Transmission Limited**, before the Commission can be accessed at the <https://www.indigrid.co.in/documents-manager/> or inspected by any person in the Commission’s office by following the laid down procedure.

5. Notice is hereby given in pursuance of clause (a) of sub-section (5) of Section 15 of the Act that suggestions or objections, if any, to the Commission’s proposal to grant a transmission licence to the applicant, as aforesaid, be sent to the undersigned by **5.8.2026** at the above noted address. The suggestions or objections received after the specified date shall not be considered.

6. The application shall be taken up for the further hearing by the Commission on **6.8.2026**. Any person who files suggestions or objections may in his/her discretion attend the hearing, for which no TA/DA shall be paid by the Commission.

Sd/-
(Harpreet Singh Pruthi)
Secretary

Business

INBRIEF



LIC appoints Shatmanyu Shrivastava as CFO

LIC on Tuesday announced the appointment of Shatmanyu Shrivastava as Executive Director (Finance & Accounts) and Chief Financial Officer. Previously he was Executive Director (Enterprise Risk Management) and Chief Risk Officer. His appointment follows the resignation of CFO Sunil Agrawal. LIC also announced the appointment of Varadarajan Muthuvenkataraman as Executive Director (Enterprise Risk Management) and Chief Risk Officer.

Former SBI CGM to liquidate Paytm Payments Bank Ltd.

The Delhi High Court has appointed former SBI chief general manager (CGM) Girikumar M. Nair to liquidate Paytm Payments Bank after the Reserve Bank of India (RBI) cancelled its banking licence three months ago. “As per the said Order, the Official Liquidator shall exercise all the powers prescribed under the provisions of the Banking Regulation Act, 1949 along with applicable provisions of the Companies Act, 2013,” the RBI said in a circular.

Ampere partners with Muthoot Capital Services

Ampere, the electric two-wheeler brand of Greaves Electric Mobility Limited, said it was partnering with Muthoot Capital Services to make electric mobility ownership more accessible and affordable. “We aim to remove financial barriers, empower customers with greater choice and convenience, and accelerate the adoption of clean mobility,” said Manoj M. P., Chief Business Officer, Greaves Electric Mobility.

City Union Bank Q1 net rises 25% to ₹383 crore

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

City Union Bank (CUB) reported a 25% year on year (YoY) rise in net profit to ₹383 crore in Q1. Interest income rose 24% to ₹1,985 crore during the quarter while interest expenses rose 19% to ₹1,165 crore. Net interest income (NII) grew 31% to ₹820 crore. Other income was almost same at ₹244 crore. Advances grew 25% to ₹67,645 crore while deposits climbed 21% to ₹79,342 crore. As of June 30, total business stood at ₹1.47 lakh crore, up 23%. Retail, agriculture and MSME portfolio accounted for 80% of the bank's total advances.

Air India FY26 loss more than doubles to ₹22,238 crore

Lalatendu Mishra
MUMBAI

Air India's financial turnaround effort suffered a major setback in FY26 with the privatised airline reporting a net loss of ₹22,238 crore, more than double it suffered in FY25, according to Tata Sons Annual Report. Revenue slid to ₹70,081 crore from ₹76,754 crore, due to scaled down operations amid geopolitical developments. Singapore Airlines, holding 25% stake in Air India, reported a Q1 loss of \$58.7 million, the first loss since 2022 when it was impacted by COVID-19. Singapore Airlines' quarterly losses were attributed to steep hike in jet



Air India's revenue dropped to ₹70,081 cr. from ₹76,754 cr.

fuel prices and mounting losses at Air India. In his message to shareholders, Tata Sons chairman N. Chandrasekaran described FY26 as the airline's 'most challenging year' since its acquisition by the Tata Group in January 2022 and attributed the

deteriorating financial performance to a combination of geopolitical tensions, operational disruptions and one-off events that significantly affected the airline's operations. “Given where it began, Air India's transformation must be seen as a five-to-ten-year journey,” he said, indicating the turnaround, planned as a five-year programme under the Vihaa.AI strategy, could now extend up to a decade. Tata Sons net rises Meanwhile for FY26, Tata Sons' revenue rose 9.1% to ₹42,367 crore while profit (after tax) climbed 21.8% to ₹31,961 crore. The board of Tata Sons has recommended a final dividend of ₹1,10,717 per share.

‘Indian space technology firms raised \$200 mn in 2025 led by Bengaluru’

Shilpa Elizabeth
BENGALURU

As India's space tech funding reached a record \$200 million in 2025 with Bengaluru emerging as the ecosystem leader attracting more than half of the money, as per market research firm Tracxn. Tracxn said in a report the sector raised about \$871 million as of July. The top 10 most-funded firms alone account for over 60% of this total, led by India's space tech unicorn, Skyroot Aerospace at \$150 million. Skyroot built Vikram-1, India's first privately developed orbital-class rocket, which successfully reached low Earth orbit on



Money state: Vikram-1, India's first privately developed orbital class rocket built by Skyroot Aerospace ahead of maiden launch. ANI

July 18.

Upward trend The report titled ‘Space Tech in India’ maps 285 firms in India with 274 being active. Out of these 72

received equity funding. From \$43 million in 2021 to \$200 million in 2025, the sector has seen a steady rise in funding in the last five years. In 2026 till date, the startups raised

\$113 million in 24 rounds. Seed-stage funding increased from \$7 million in 2022 to \$62 million in 2025 while late-stage funding emerged for the first time, reaching \$17 million in 2025 and \$53 million in 2026 YTD signalling a subset of firms transitioning from development to pre-commercial operations. The investor base also expanded from domestic venture capital firms and angel investors to sovereign wealth funds and global institutional investors. However, the increase in funding during 2025-26 has been driven by a small number of large rounds rather than a broad-based rise in deal activity.

India curtailed 8,133 GWh solar power to maintain grid security

As on June 30, India's installed solar power capacity stood at 162.15 GW, which included 30.11 GW of rooftop projects, 6.43 GW of off-grid project

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

Wasted energy

Restriction due to mismatch between commissioning of transmission lines and renewable energy projects, MoS tells House



- Curtailment is when power-grid operators limit output from generating sources
- 2,417 GWh of solar energy curtailment was carried out in April this year
- 3,235 GWh of solar energy was restricted in May and 2,481 GWh in June

Real Creator IAS Edition https://t.me/+8B98m5PQCF84MmQ9 May and 2,481 GWh in June. As on June 30, India has installed solar capacity of up to 162.15 GW, which is inclusive of 125.6 GW of utility scale projects, 30.11 GW of rooftop projects and 6.43 GW of off-grid projects.

PM Surya Ghar

Separately, Mr. Naik also told the upper house that since its implementation in February 2024, the PM Surya Ghar scheme has reached out to more than 48 lakh households having released ₹27,343.9 crore as Central Financial Assistance (CFA) until June 27.

HUL shares plummet 7% as Q1 PAT declines 3% to ₹2,673 crore

The Hindu Bureau
MUMBAI

Shares of Hindustan Unilever Ltd. (HUL) plunged 7% on the Bombay Stock Exchange (BSE) on Wednesday as the company's quarterly results fell short of investors' expectations, even as it saw higher revenues.

HUL's first-quarter net profit fell 3% year-on-year (YoY) to ₹2,673 crore due to one-off tax credit gain made in the year-earlier period. Rising input costs and inflationary pressures remained key challenges, affecting operating margins during the quarter.

However, the company delivered the highest revenue growth in 13 quarters, with underlying sales growth (USG) of 10%, supported by higher sales volumes and selective price increases.

USG refers to the increase in turnover for the period, excluding any change resulting from acquisitions and disposals. Revenue from sales



Revenue from sales jumped 10.26% YoY to ₹17,149 crore

jumped 10.26% YoY to ₹17,149 crore.

“Despite global geopolitical volatility, the Indian economy demonstrated resilience, supported by proactive fiscal and monetary policy measures. The underlying demand environment remained stable during the quarter. Against this backdrop, HUL delivered a turnover of ₹17,184 crore and 10% USG, driven equally by volume and price. This marks our highest growth in thirteen quarters,” said Priya Nair, CEO and MD, HUL.

Analysts said that the company's performance reflected resilient consumer demand, particularly in rural markets.

ONGC okays \$500 mn PCG for MRPL for Saudi Aramco crude import

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

State-owned Oil and Natural Gas Corp (ONGC) said on Tuesday that it had approved a \$500-million parent company guarantee (PCG) in favour of Saudi Aramco on behalf of subsidiary Mangalore Refinery and Petrochemicals Ltd. (MRPL) enabling them to import crude oil from Saudi Aramco.

“The board of directors, at its meeting held today has inter-alia approved the proposal to provide parent company guarantee (PCG) of \$500 million in favour of Saudi Arabian Oil Company (Saudi Aramco) for the period 01.09.2026 to 31.08.2028 on behalf of (MRPL), to enable MRPL to import crude oil from Saudi Aramco,” ONGC informed the bourses in an exchange filing.

The guarantee would be applicable for a period of approximately two years, i.e., between September 1, 2026 and August 31, 2028.

India, strongest growth market for Germany

Gurmehar Kaur
NEW DELHI

With India emerging as one of its strongest growth markets, the German National Tourist Office (GNTTO) has unveiled its four campaign themes for this year, while Germany's national carrier Lufthansa

confirmed a €3 billion investment to lift its India-bound fleet, including doubling the capacity in its Mumbai-Munich route by upgrading it with an Airbus A380. The Lufthansa group is also expanding its India network through Swiss International Air Lines, which will begin fly-

ing Zurich to Bangalore, its newest India route. These announcements came as GNTTO unveiled four campaign themes for 2026 – culture, city life, cuisine and nature, and as Lufthansa marked its 100th year of operations. Kevin Markette, Senior Director, Sales, South Asia,

Lufthansa Group, said “The clearest demonstration of Lufthansa's commitment to India is that we are bringing our newest technology and product to the market.” Fuel efficiency is a priority as sustainability concerns shape airline investment decisions industry-wide, he added.

L&T Q1 consolidated net up 14% to ₹4,123 cr.

The Hindu Bureau
MUMBAI

Larsen & Toubro Ltd. (L&T) for the first quarter ended June 30, 2026 posted a consolidated profit after tax (PAT) of ₹4,123

crore, registering a 14% YoY growth, owing to operational excellence and treasury gains, its President, Whole-time Director and Chief Financial Officer (CFO) R. Shankar Raman said.

BRIDCUL (ब्रिडकुल)
ब्रिज, रोपवे, टनल एण्ड अदर इन्फ्रास्ट्रक्चर डेवलपमेंट कॉर्पोरेशन ऑफ़ सत्तराखण्ड लिमिटेड (सत्तराखण्ड सरकार का उपक्रम)
पूर्व में सत्तराखण्ड राज्य अवस्थाना विकास निगम लिमिटेड. प्रधान कार्यालय: अवस्थाना सदन, 583, ठ, राजकीय बाईपैदीआर्शो निरंजनपुर के सामने, माजरा, सहायपुर रोड, देहरादून, टेलीफोन नं.: 0135-2522941 ई-मेल: bridcul@gmail.com CIN No. U45203UR2008SGC032591

Ref No.: -1149/BRIDCUL-1077(2)/26 Date: 28/07/2026

E-Tendering (2nd Call)

On behalf of Hon'ble, Governor of Uttarakhand, E-Tenders are invited by Managing Director BRIDCUL, from the Contractors registered with any Govt./Semi Govt./PSU/Nigam in suitable Class & Category for the works given as below:-

S. No	Ref No.	Name of Project	Estimated Cost (In lac Including GST)	Earnest Money (In Lac)	Cost of Tender Document (In Rs.)	Time Period
1	BRIDCUL/HQ DDN/18/2026-27	HVAC & Lift work of Proposed Regional Office Building for Pollution Board at Dehradun.	75.99	1.52	5000+ 18% GST	15 Months

For above tenders, document download start date is **30.07.2026** and Bid submission end date is **13.08.2026** at 1500 Hrs. The details of e-tender of above works can be obtained directly from website <https://uktenders.gov.in>
Changes, if any will be intimated only through website <https://uktenders.gov.in>

DGM (HQ)

BHAKRA BEAS MANAGEMENT BOARD
NOTICE INVITING E-TENDER

Name of Office	NIT No. / Name of work	Starting Date (Time) Closing Date (Time) Opening Date (Time)	Tender Fee/ Estimate Cost/ Earnest Money
Additional Superintending Engineer, Nangal Dam Division, Nangal Township, Distt. Ropar- 140 124 (PB)	NIT No. 214/ 2026/ NDD,	25/07/26 at 1100 hrs. 24/08/26 upto 15:30 PM 25/08/26 at 1500 hrs.	Rs. 27,58,623.00 Rs. 55,180.00
Executive Engineer, Bhakra Dam Division, BBMB, Nangal Township	NIT No. 246/ B D D / 2 0 2 6	25/07/26 at 9:00 AM 25/08/26 at 3:00 PM 26/08/26 at 3:30 PM	Rs. 94,08,000.00 Rs. 1,88,160.00
Sr Executive Engineer, Township Division, BBMB, Sundernagar.	NIT No. 2/ 2026/ NDD,	25/07/26 upto 17:00 PM 24/08/26 upto 15:30 PM 25/08/26 upto 15:30 PM	Rs. 16,93,464/- Rs. 33,900/-
Sr. Executive Engineer, Electrical & Workshop Division, BBMB, Sundernagar	NIT No. 02/ 2026-27- EWDSnr	24/07/26 at 3:00 PM 13/08/26 at 3:00 PM 14/08/26 at 3:00 PM	Rs. 10,40,000.00 Rs. 20,800.00
Executive Engineer, O&M Division, BBMB, Delhi	E-NIT-09/ OMD/ 2026-27	24/07/26 at 18:00 hrs. 25/08/26 at 12:00 hrs.	Rs. 9,61,252.00 Rs. 9,615.00
Addl. S.E., O & M Division BBMB Jamalpur Ludhiana	NIT No. 08/ 2026-27	29/07/26 at 10:00 hrs. 28/08/26 at 15:00 hrs.	Rs. 24,19,995/- Rs. 25,000/-

Dated:- 28.07.2026 E-Tender for Re-Construction of damage retaining wall and stone pitching of Tower No. 1 and 2 at Bhakra-Jamalpur D/C Line.

For detailed NIT/terms & conditions etc. please visit/downloaded from BBMB website www.bbmb.gov.in, www.etenders.gov.in
NOTE: If any Corrigendum, shall be uploaded on website only.
304-PR-Bd.Sectt.-4 FOR YOUR BETTER TOMORROW SAVE ENERGY TODAY

BENGALURU CENTRAL CITY CORPORATION
Office of the Executive Engineer, Traffic Engineering Cell Division
Room No: 09, Ground Floor, Annex Building-3, Greater Bengaluru
Authority Office Premises, N R Square, Bengaluru-560002

No: BCCC/TEC/Tend/05/2025-26/Call-3 Date: 28.07.2026

INVITATION FOR TENDER (IFT)
(Two Cover System)

(Through GOK KPP Portal <https://kppp.karnataka.gov.in> only)

The Executive Engineer (TEC-BCCC) for invites Proposals (Technical and Financial) for appointing eligible reputed Service Providers for the services as given below.

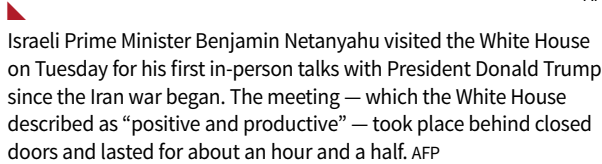
Sl. No.	Name of the Project
1.	Providing Emergency Relief Task Force Team for Bengaluru Central City Corporation (BCCC) Control Room. Approximate Amount put to Tender : Rs. 300.00 Lakhs. EMD : 5.00 Lakhs (Rs. One Lakh through e-payment & remaining as specified in bid document).

Calendar of Events : (1) Availability of RFP online: **28.07.2026 onwards.** (2) Last Date for Receipt of Tender is **07.08.2026 up to 17.00 Hrs.** (3) Date of opening of technical Bid is **10.08.2026 at 11.00 Hrs.** (4) Date of opening of financial Bid after approval of technical bid.

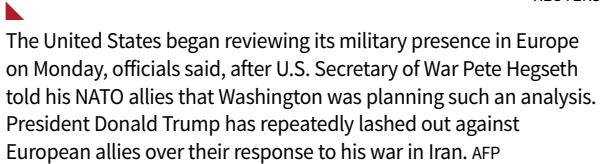
Sd/- Executive Engineer, Traffic Engineering Cell Division, BCCC

GOVERNMENT OF HIMACHAL PRADESH
JAL SHAKTI VIBHAG
“NOTICE INVITING e-TENDER”
The Executive Engineer, Jal Shakti Division, Solan invites e-tender on behalf of Governor of Himachal Pradesh from approved eligible contractors/firms for the following work through e-tendering process:
Sr. No. 1.
Name of work.:- Operation, repair & maintenance of sewerage scheme to Solan Town in Tehsil and Distt Solan H.P. (SH) -Operation, repair & maintenance of 2.90 MLD capacity Sewage Treatment Plant (STP) with tertiary treatment and sewerage network of Zone-B for three years).
Estimated cost.:- 1,32,04,788/-, **Earnest Money.:-** 2,07,050/-, **Time of Completion. :-** 3 Years, **Cost of form.:-** 5000/-, **Last date of filing/ uploading the tender through e-tendering upto:-** 17.08.2026 upto 11.00A.M
The tender forms and other detailed can be obtained from website <http://www.hpph.org>
Executive Engineer,
Jal Shakti Division, Solan
HP / 2189/26-27 HIM SUCHNA AVAM JAN SAMPARK

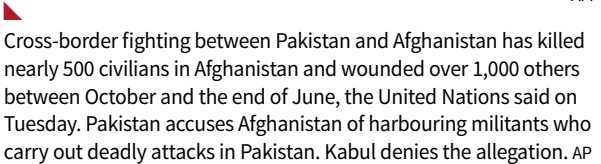
Netanyahu visits White House for first Trump talks during Iran war



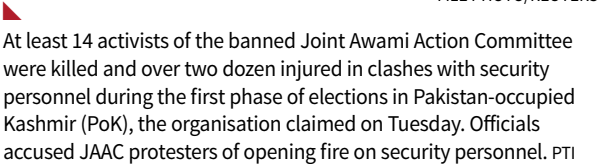
U.S. begins review of force presence in Europe amid Trump ire on NATO



Months of cross-border fighting killed 500 Afghan civilians: UN



14 killed, dozens injured in clashes with security forces in PoK: JAAC

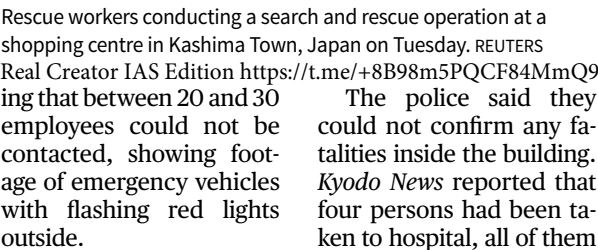


A 7.1-magnitude earthquake struck Japan, reaching the highest level of seven on Shindo shaking scale; a shopping mall in Kashima was reported to have people trapped inside after its second floor collapsed in a fire; over 100 reportedly injured

“Many people” were feared trapped in a stricken shopping mall in Japan late on Tuesday, authorities said, after a major earthquake toppled buildings, sparked fires and reportedly injured more than 100.

Private broadcaster *TBS* reported that a "considerable number" were feared dead inside the mall in the town of Kashima after the fire brigade said that the second floor collapsed in the 7.1-magnitude tremor.

Public broadcaster *NHK* cited police sources as say-



conscious. Multiple people were also believed to be unaccounted for at a Japan Paper Industries factory where the tip of a chimney fell down, *NHK* reported, citing sources.

One person was killed when a house collapsed during the quake, *Kyodo* reported.

Widespread damage
Footage elsewhere in the southwestern Kumamoto region on the island of Kyushu aired by *NHK* earlier showed several blazes, damaged bridges, a derailed cargo train and a number of houses threatening to topple over.

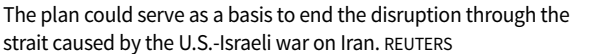
The tremor had a mag-

nitude of 7.1, the Japan Meteorological Agency (JMA) said, but reached the highest level of seven on Japan's Shindo scale of shaking. A succession of aftershocks followed, including one with a magnitude of 6.1.

Many roads were closed and high-speed shinkansen train services were suspended in the region. Kumamoto airport was closed before being re-opened on Tuesday evening.

"We are still assessing the extent of injuries and property damage, but I have been informed that there have already been several injuries," Prime Minister Sanae Takaichi said.

Oman has presented Iran with a plan backed by Gulf states to manage the Strait of Hormuz, including collecting voluntary fees for using it, a Gulf source and a Western diplomat told *Reuters* on Tuesday. The plan could serve as a basis to end the disruption through the strait caused by the U.S.-Israeli war on Iran.



U.S. President Donald Trump, who abruptly called off a two-week bombing campaign over the weekend in his latest strategic U-turn, said there were "good talks" under way with Iran but threatened to restart strikes unless negotiations deliver. Iran denies seeking to resume talks with the United States. Under the Omani

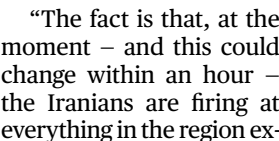
proposal, Iran would not exercise sole control and fees would be voluntary. The system would be analogous to one in place on Asia's Strait of Malacca, where Indonesia, Malaysia and Singapore ask ships to pay voluntary contributions to fund navigation, environmental protection and search-and-rescue op-

erations. The Western diplomat compared it to a voluntary carbon tax for flights, where anyone buying a plane ticket can choose to tick a box if they want to pay to offset their emissions.

The Gulf source said that there had been no formal response from Iran to the proposal.

Israeli Defence Minister Israel Katz on Tuesday said that American warplanes used Israeli bases during their attacks on Iran, reiterating that his country was prepared to retaliate if targeted.

Fighting between the U.S. and Iran has been paused since Friday after

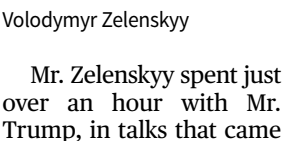


cept one country: the State of Israel," Mr. Katz told Israel's right-wing *Channel*

14. "They know that American aircraft are taking off from here to carry out strikes," he added.

"This does not mean we know what will happen tomorrow; it means we know what our response will be. I announced it, the Prime Minister announced it, and we made it absolutely clear: if Israel comes under fire, we will strike back with full force," he said.

Ukrainian President Volodymyr Zelenskyy hailed a "good meeting" with U.S. counterpart Donald Trump at the White House on Tuesday, saying they discussed licences to produce Patriot air-defence interceptors and ways to revive negotiations with Russia.



with Kyiv and Moscow intensifying long-range strikes and U.S.-led diplomatic efforts to end the war stalled.

“Thank you for everything we do together to protect the lives of Ukrainians and advance peace,” Mr. Zelenskyy said afterward in a statement on X.

“The President and I discussed licenses for Patriot interceptor produc-

tion and several other ideas that could help," he added. "We also spoke about diplomacy – it's important that the diplomatic process be reinvigorated."

White House press secretary Karoline Leavitt described the meeting as "positive and productive."

Mr. Zelensky said he had also offered Mr. Trump his condolences over senator Lindsey Graham's death.

social capacity for a future democratic transition.

war". While stressing that PJAK does not believe war is a path to democracy, he argued that the roots of the conflict lie in the Islamic Republic's "repressive domestic policies and its expansionist policies across the region". He said the group views "pressure on this dictatorial regime and strikes against its centres of repression" as positive, provided civilians are not harmed and the future right to self-determination of Iran's peoples is not undermined.

On relations with Washington and Tel Aviv, Mr. Abdanan said PJAK keeps "diplomatic channels open to all governments and political actors" whose engagement serves Kurdish interests and supports "the establishment of a democratic political system in Iran".

At the same time, he noted that many Iranian Kurds remain sceptical of both powers, citing what he called America's inconsistent policies towards Syrian Kurds and the lasting memory of Israel's alleged role in the capture of Kurdish leader Abdullah Öcalan.

The Kurdistan Free Life Party (PJAK), an armed Kurdish group and political party based in Iran's Kurdistan region, says it will not join the U.S.-Israel war against Iran unless the "existence of the Kurdish people comes under threat", insisting that it is "not anyone's proxy force" but a movement seeking a democratic transformation of Iran.

In an email interview with *The Hindu*, Rivar Abdanan, a PJAK spokesperson and member of the party's Leadership Council, said the group rejects being viewed merely as a military actor and instead seeks to build "a democratic, self-administered society" in Kurdistan while working towards "the establishment of a democratic republic throughout Iran".

Mr. Abdanan said PJAK's military posture is guided by self-defence and political strategy rather than opportunism. "The Islamic Republic wants to drag us into a long and exhausting war," he said, adding that the party wants to preserve Kurdish political and

 BANGALORE WATER SUPPLY AND SEWERAGE BOARD		
INVITATION FOR TENDER (Through KPP Portal Only)		
BWSSB invites Tenders in Two Stage Tender System from eligible contractors for the following works.		
Sl No.	Name of the Works	Amount put to Tender EMD Amount
Office of the Chief Engineer (West), 6th Floor, Cauvery Bhavan, K.G Road, Bengaluru- 560 009.		
No:BWSSB/EIC/CE(W)/ACE(W)-II/DCE(W)/TA(W)/2141/2026-27		Dated:28.07.2026
1.	Work of providing and laying of 300mm & 100mm dia DI Water pipeline up to White Topping by GBA at 9th Main from 24th Cross up to 13th Cross, BSK 2nd Stage coming under Ganesh Mandira Service Station of AEE W-4-3 Sub division.	₹ 114.41 Lakhs ₹ 2.00 Lakhs
No:BWSSB/EIC/CE(W)/ACE(W)-II/DCE(W)/TA(W)/2142/2026-27		Dated:28.07.2026
2.	Work of providing and laying 300mm Dia RCC NP3 Class & 230mm Dia GSW Sewer line for proposed white topping road at 9th Main 24th Cross & 21st Main up to 13th cross comes under Ganesh Mandira Service Station of AEE W-4-3 Sub Division.	₹ 156.12 Lakhs ₹ 2.35 Lakhs
For all the above works, the Last date and time for Receipt of tenders: 12-08-2026 upto 17:00 hours. Tender will be opened on 13-08-2026 after 17:30 hours.		
Sd/- Chief Engineer (West)		
The details regarding participation in the e-procurement portal process can be obtained by logging on to https://kppp.karnataka.gov.in For further details contact the above signed office during working hours.		
DIPR/CP/1857/CCL/2026-27		

COMMANDING SHOW

Jadumani storms into semifinals, ensures India another medal



SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

Jadumani Singh stormed into the semifinals of the men's 55kg boxing event with a commanding 5-0 victory over Zambia's Mwengo Mwale at the Commonwealth Games in Glasgow on Tuesday. The Indian, who looked fluent throughout the bout, is assured of at least a bronze medal.

MIXED BAG

Vishal qualifies for the 400m semifinal even as Rajesh bows out



X@MEDIA_SAI

National record holder Vishal T.K. (46.49s) kept India's medal hopes alive in the men's 400m after qualifying for the semifinals, while compatriot Rajesh Ramesh (47.43s) narrowly missed the cut in the athletics competition at the Commonwealth Games on Tuesday. The 22-year-old Vishal finished second in Round 1 Heat 6.

MOVING ON

Ten Doeschate departs from India's coaching staff



FILE PHOTO: R. RAGU

Ryan ten Doeschate has stepped down as India's assistant coach, bringing an end to a stint with the team that began alongside Gautam Gambhir's appointment as head coach in July 2024. The Dutchman is understood to have tendered his resignation following the conclusion of India's recent tour of England — **Amol Karhadkar**.

ALMOST THERE

West Indies one wicket away from winning the opening Test



AFP

West Indies was one wicket away from beating Pakistan when tea was called on the fourth day of the opening Test in Tarouba on Tuesday. **The scores:** West Indies 311 & 181 in 54.5 overs (Mohammad Abbas 5/22) vs Pakistan 282 & 114/9 in 39 overs (Babar Azam 53 batting, Jayden Seales 4/20) **at tea**.



Ending a drought: Sharmila and Shilpa ended a 20-year wait for a CWG para athletics medal. PTI

Sharmila claims gold in para shot put F57

C'WEALTH GAMES
Press Trust of India
GLASGOW

Sharmila Dhankar scripted history on Monday as she won India's first para athletics gold medal in the Commonwealth Games, clinching the top spot in the women's shot put F57 event here.

The 40-year-old produced a season-best throw of 9.81m to end India's 20-year wait for a para athletics medal in the CWG.

Another Indian, Shilpa Shyla, was awarded the bronze medal following an Indian protest in controversial circumstances. Shyla had produced a personal best effort of 7.26m.

Nigeria's Eucharía Iyiazi was initially placed at the bronze medal position but after a protest and official review, her only valid mark was adjudged a foul. That led to Shyla being upgraded to bronze from initial

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fourth place. However, it is likely that a counter protest may also be launched by Nigeria.

F57 classification is for athletes with lower limb impairments, limb deficiencies, or reduced muscle power.

Infected with polio on her left leg at the age of two, Sharmila won a gold medal in the Fazza International Para Athletics Championship this year. She also took part in the 2022 Birmingham Games and finished fourth.

Meanwhile, India's Srihari Nataraj qualified for the 100m backstroke semifinals but veteran Sanjay Prakash failed to go past the Heats of 50m butterfly event on Tuesday. Srihari finished fifth in his Heat and 13th overall with a timing of 55.58 seconds. The 16 fastest swimmers advanced to the semifinals. Sajan, however, failed to qualify after finishing eighth in his Heat and 28th overall.

Kushare clinches a historic silver for India in high jump

The 31-year-old is the first from the country to finish second in the discipline at the Games; Jamaica's Beckford takes home the gold; injuries dash the hopes of Tejaswin and hurdler Shirse

K. Keerthivasan
GLASGOW

For every attempt by Sarvesh Kushare in the men's high jump final of the Commonwealth Games at the Scotstoun Stadium here on Monday, the modest gathering of spectators responded with warm applause and cheers. But when the Indian stepped up for his third and final attempt at 2.28m in expectations of a gold medal — after Romaine Beckford had failed to clear the same height in his final attempt — sepulchral silence descended over the stadium. It was evident that the crowd wanted the 31-year-old Indian to win.

However, it wasn't to be. Kushare settled for the silver medal — the first for India in able-bodied athletics at this Games. It was also the first silver by an Indian high jumper at the quadrennial event.

Beckford had sailed past 2.25m in his first try, while the Indian National record holder managed the same height only in his third, handing the Jamaican the gold on countback.

"I am happy to win a medal in my second Commonwealth Games. The cold weather affected my warm-up and warm-down routine. I was a bit con-



No time to relax: Kushare said he will now focus on the Asian Games. AFP
Real Creator IAS Edition https://whatsapp.com/channel/0029Van2VRb6RGJOKH6oBd0F

fused, but it was a good learning experience and a lot of fun. I won't relax now and will focus on the Asian Games," said Kushare.

However, it turned out to be a disappointing day for Tejaswin Sankar, the bronze medallist at the 2022 Birmingham Commonwealth Games.

Initially, there was confusion when the official Commonwealth Games website displayed a DNS (Did Not Start) against his name.

When queried, officials said it was a "technical glitch". A few minutes later, spectators saw Tejaswin on the stadium's giant screen

waving at them.

The 27-year-old failed in his opening attempt at 2.05m before retiring from the competition.

Later, Tejaswin said he withdrew because of severe pain caused by tendonitis in his knee.

"I think I've always had tendonitis in my knee. There isn't a high jumper in the world who hasn't suffered tendonitis. It was just one of those days. I was confident of doing well and winning a medal. In fact, I was feeling good and was in great shape during my warm-up," he said while trying to control his tears.

Tejaswin said he would now focus on recovering in time for his next event, the decathlon on Friday.

"I'll try to fix this injury. I'm not on vacation. There are two days before my next event, and I'll start my recovery," he said.

Jack Kimani of England finished third (2.2m), while the third Indian in the field, Adarsh Ram, came fifth (2.15).

Meanwhile, Tejas Shirse finished eighth and last in the men's 110m hurdles final in 15.39 seconds and was seen limping towards the end of the race.

"I felt pain in my left ankle during the warm-up before the race," Shirse said.

Ajaya wins silver, does one better than dad

K. Keerthivasan
GLASGOW

Ajaya Babu grew up accompanying his father, Valuri Srinivasa Rao, to weightlifting competitions, learning the finer aspects of the sport from him. Inspired by Rao, who won a bronze medal in the men's 56kg category at the 2010 Commonwealth Games in New Delhi, Ajaya arrived in Glasgow for his debut

Games determined to make his dad proud.

He did exactly that, although he was left disappointed after missing the gold by a whisker in the men's 79kg event at the Scottish Event Campus here on Monday night.

The 21-year-old from Kondavelagada village in Andhra Pradesh's Vizianagaram district finished with the silver.

He managed a total lift

of 330kg, just 1kg behind Malaysia's Muhammad Erry Hidayat, who created Games records in clean and jerk (184) and total (331). Ajaya, too, produced a Games record of 149 in snatch while Hidayat managed 147. Ajaya lifted 181 in clean and jerk.

"I should have done better. I dedicate the medal to Indian Weightlifting Federation, coaches, support staff and my father. I fol-

lowed the sport after seeing my father who has been my inspiration. I wanted to win gold but couldn't. I will try to win it next time," Ajaya said.

Nirupama Devi failed to clear 123kg on all three clean and jerk attempts, resulting in a no-mark in the section and a DNF in the women's 63kg final. She was placed fifth after snatch with a best lift of 93kg.



Fine show: Ajaya produced a Games record of 149kg in snatch. GETTY IMAGES

Indian women edge past Australia, book semifinal spot

C'WEALTH TT
Amol Karhadkar
NEW DELHI

India overcame a spirited Australia to begin the second stage of the women's team event at the 22nd Commonwealth Table Tennis Championships with a hard-fought victory at the Thyagaraja Sports Complex on Tuesday.

The evening session marked the start of the second stage — effectively the Super Eight — and Australia ensured the top seed was made to work for every



Minor scare: Manav being treated by doctors after hurting his forehead during the match against Australia. AMOL KARHADKAR

point. Yangzi Liu, the highest-ranked Australian singles player, was the standout performer, racing past both Yashaswini Ghorpade and Sreeja Akula without dropping a game.

Yashaswini, however, bounced back admirably. Showing remarkable composure after her opening defeat, the youngster outlasted the experienced Min Hyung Jee in the deciding

rubber to confirm India's entry into the semifinals.

The Indian women had eased past Sri Lanka 3-0 earlier in the afternoon.

The defining performance of the tie, though, came from Olympian Sutirtha Mukherjee.

Locked in a tense battle against Constantina Psihogios in the third singles, Sutirtha relied on her experience and timely winners to edge a gripping five-game contest. She clinched the decider 13-11.

Sreeja lost to Liu as Australia made it 2-2 before Yashaswini sealed the tie.

The Indian men, mean-

while, enjoyed a more comfortable outing against Australia. World No. 38 Manav Thakkar shrugged off a cut on his forehead — sustained after colliding with the umpire's desk during the second game — to complete his singles victory as India sealed the tie 3-0.

G. Sathiyam has withdrawn from the men's singles competition.

Sathiyam confirmed to *The Hindu* that he will, however, compete in the men's doubles alongside Harmeet Desai and in the mixed doubles with Sreeja. "Both these events will serve as preparation for the

Asian Games," he said.

Top results: Second stage: Women: India bt Australia 3-2 (Yashaswini Ghorpade lost to Yangzi Liu 13-15, 9-11, 5-11; Sreeja Akula bt Min Hyung Jee 12-10, 7-11, 11-5, 11-9; Sutirtha Mukherjee bt Constantina Psihogios 11-8, 9-11, 8-11, 11-8, 13-11; Yangzi bt Sreeja 11-8, 11-5, 11-5; Yashaswini bt Min 11-5, 11-9, 11-8); India bt Sri Lanka 3-0; Canada bt Sri Lanka 3-0; Australia bt Canada 3-0.

Men: India bt Australia 3-0 (Manush Shah bt Nicholas Lum 11-7, 9-11, 12-10, 11-13, 11-3; Manav Thakkar bt Chulong Nie 11-7, 11-6, 11-4; G. Sathiyam bt Aditya Sareen 11-8, 11-8, 11-8); Malaysia bt Maldives 3-1; Sri Lanka bt Namibia 3-0.

Jadeja is back

After being rested for the one-off Test against Afghanistan in New Chandigarh in June, Ravindra Jadeja has made a return. The 37-year-old all-rounder is one of four spinners at Shubman Gill's disposal, along with Saransh, Manav Suthar and Kuldeep Yadav. Manav had thoroughly impressed with a match haul of seven for 62 on debut versus Afghanistan.

Jasprit Bumrah has also returned to spearhead the pace attack, but his selec-

pressive, her defence was equally effective. Whenever Clyde tried to close the gap, Preeti was quick to evade or block her rival's punches.

Clyde fought hard but the Indian remained a step ahead throughout, comfortably taking the third round to complete a comprehensive victory.

"I would like to thank all the Indians for their blessings and prayers. There were many challenges in my life, and now I am able to understand my game better. I gave my 100% to-day and will give my 100% in the next bout as well," said an elated Preeti.

She added her training camp in Belfast, where she sparred with Clyde before the Games, also helped her.

Later, Priya Ghanghas assured another medal by beating Scotland's Niamh Mitchell 4-1 on points in the women's 60kg quarter-final bout.

Parveen Hooda lost her women's 65kg quarterfinal to England's Sacha Hickey 2-3 in a split verdict.

Saransh makes it to the Test team

Vivek Krishnan
NEW DELHI

Off-spinner Saransh Jain has earned a maiden call-up to India's Test squad for a two-match series against Sri Lanka next month. The two Tests will be played in Galle (August 15-19) and Colombo (August 23-27). In preparation for the series, the Indian team will play a four-day practice match in Colombo from August 7.

Saransh's opportunity comes on the back of off-spinning all-rounder Washington Sundar sustaining a hamstring injury during the ODI series against England. The BCCI stated that Washington wasn't available for the first Test, and hence has been left out altogether.

Saransh, who plays for Madhya Pradesh in domestic cricket, has picked up 188 scalps in 54 First Class appearances. The 33-year-old bats left-handed, and can contribute lower down the order. He has been part of the India-A set-up since February 2024.



Saransh. FILE PHOTO: K. MURALI KUMAR

tion is subject to fitness. He missed the last ODI on the tour of England after sustaining an injury to his left knee. Mohammed Siraj, Prasidh Krishna and Gurnoor Brar are the other quicks in the 15-member squad.

In the batting unit, Sai Sudharsan's inclusion also came with a caveat that his fitness will have to be cleared by the BCCI's Centre of Excellence (CoE). On India-A's recent tour of Sri Lanka, comprising two four-day games, the south-paw had starred with two hundreds.

The squad: Shubman Gill (Capt.), K.L. Rahul (Vice-captain), Yashasvi Jaiswal, Rishabh Pant (wk), Sai Sudharsan, Dhruv Jurel (wk), Ravindra Jadeja, Kuldeep Yadav, Manav Suthar, Jasprit Bumrah, Mohammed Siraj, Prasidh Krishna, Gurnoor Brar, Devdutt Padikkal, and Saransh Jain.

Note: Sai Sudharsan and Bumrah's selection subject to fitness.

INBRIEF



Gvardiol signs new five-year deal at Manchester City

Josko Gvardiol has signed a new five-year contract at Manchester City, the Premier League club announced on Tuesday. The Croatia international, whose previous deal had two years left to run, is now committed until 2031, with the option of an additional 12 months. The central defender made 122 appearances since arriving from RB Leipzig for £77 million in 2023.

Indian women go down to Malaysia in World jr. squash

Recently crowned World junior champion Anahat Singh won her contest but the Indian women’s team went down fighting 1-2 to Malaysia in a World Squash junior team championship contest in Ontario, Canada. Anahat brushed aside the challenge from Whitney Wilson 11-2, 11-4, 11-5 in the concluding match after India lost the first two. In the opening match, Rudra Singh lost to Harleen Tan 5-11, 4-11, 6-11 while Anika Dubey was involved in a five-game thriller with Ye San Lee before going down 8-11, 11-8, 11-8, 10-12, 9-11. The team will next take on South Africa, while the men will face off against Kuwait.

Punjab FC signs forward Gurkirat and Nishchal

Punjab FC has bolstered its squad ahead of the 2026-27 Indian Super League (ISL) season with the double signing of forward Gurkirat Singh and defender Nishchal Chandan. Both players have signed two-year agreements that will keep them with the Shers until May 31, 2028.

Laver Cup: Ruud completes Team Europe’s line-up

Europe’s line-up for the Laver Cup in London has been completed with Norway’s Casper Ruud named as the sixth member of the team to take on Team World. The World No. 13 will join Alexander Zverev, Carlos Alcaraz, Flavio Cobolli, Jakub Mensik and Rafael Jodar for the September 25-27 event. Team World, which will be captained by Andre Agassi, includes Alex de Minaur, Ben Shelton, Taylor Fritz, Learner Tien, Tommy Paul and Alexander Bublik.

Cucurella keeps De la Fuente tattoo pledge after WC win

Marc Cucurella revealed a new tattoo of coach Luis de la Fuente on his arm on Tuesday, keeping a promise he made before the country’s World Cup win. The left-back vowed at the start of the summer to get a tattoo of the coach’s face if Spain won the tournament. In the tattoo, De la Fuente is depicted wearing a suit and brandishing the World Cup.

LIVE TELECAST

▼

CWG 2026: Day 6, Sony Sports Ten 2 & LIV, 1 p.m.

Durand Cup: Sony Sports Ten 5 & LIV, 7 p.m.

Gukesh to defend his title against Sindarov in Geneva

The Indian had won the World championship by beating China’s Ding in Singapore two years ago while his Uzbek rival earned the right to be the challenger after winning the Candidates

CHESS

P.K. Ajith Kumar

Geneva will host the World chess championship match between D. Gukesh and Javokhir Sindarov from November 25 to December 15. Chennai-based Gukesh had won the title by beating China’s Ding Liren in Singapore two years ago while his Uzbek rival earned the right to be the challenger after winning the Candidates tournament. Both players are aged 20, making it the youngest World title match in history. Viswanathan Anand, world chess governing body FIDE’s interim president, said several countries, including India, the United States, and Cyprus, had expressed interest to host the event. “FIDE has decided to stage the match on neutral soil and bring it to Geneva,



It’s a date! Sindarov will contest Gukesh for the world crown from November 25 to December 15. FILE PHOTO

a city with a historic tradition of bringing nations and cultures together,” said the five-time World champion. “We look forward to welcoming the global chess community to Switzerland. The local chess fans will have the opportunity to experience world-class chess in per-

son, while fans around the globe can follow online as the duel for the highest title in chess unfolds.” President of the Swiss Chess Federation Andre Voegtlin said it was a truly special day for Swiss chess. “Twenty-two years after Brissago (2004 World title match), an event of major global chess significance is

returning to Switzerland. It’s a moment that fills us with joy and motivation.” Though Gukesh has had to go through some tough times after becoming the youngest ever World champion, in sharp contrast to the rapid rise of Sindarov, it should be a fascinating match between the two young men.

South United beats CISF Protectors

DURAND CUP

Sports Bureau KOLKATA

South United FC climbed to the top of Group-A with a comfortable 2-0 win over CISF Protectors in the 135th Durand Cup at the Kishore Bharati Stadium on Tuesday. After a barren first half, the Bengaluru-based side broke the deadlock in the 65th minute from a corner. A powerful header by Roman James struck the upright before reaching Rishik Shetty, who tapped

home the rebound. South United sealed the victory in the 84th minute when substitute Ashish Chetry guided B. Abhiram’s measured cross into the net. The win took South United to the top of the standings on goal difference ahead of Mohun Bagan Super Giant, with both teams on three points.

Goalless draw Meanwhile, the Group-D opener between Imphal rivals TRAU FC and NEROCA FC ended in a goalless draw at the Khuman Lampak Stadium. Both teams created sev-

eral scoring opportunities in a closely contested encounter but failed to convert their chances. TRAU was reduced to 10 men after Ugandan midfielder Adriko Rogers was sent off for receiving his second yellow card. However, NEROCA failed to capitalise on the numerical advantage, and the match ended in a hard-fought 0-0 stalemate. The results: Group- A (Kolkata): South United FC 2 (Rishik Shetty 65, Ashish Chetry 84) bt CISF Protectors 0. Group- D (Imphal): NEROCA FC 0 drew with TRAU FC 0.

City’s Rodri sidelined for ‘short period’

Agence France-Presse LONDON

Spain’s World Cup-winning captain Rodri will be sidelined for a short period following a minor back surgery, Manchester City said on Tuesday. “Manchester City can confirm Rodri has undergone successful minor back surgery,” the Premier League club said. “He has undergone a procedure to address the issue and will begin a short period of rehabilitation.”

Djokovic-Sabalenka duo tops US Open pairings

TENNIS

Agence France-Presse PARIS

Serbian tennis legend Novak Djokovic and women’s No. 1 Aryna Sabalenka top the list of pairings entered for the US Open mixed doubles. Both men’s World No.1 Jannik Sinner and second-ranked Carlos Alcaraz have not entered the competition which was heavily revamped last year.



Huge draw: Djokovic and Sabalenka will be watched with interest.

Reforms featured a shorter scoring format in the earlier rounds and a new scheduling slot – played ov-

er two days – before the singles draws in an attempt to encourage the top players to enter.

Djokovic, 39, and the 28-year-old Sabalenka are certain to feature among the initial six pairings selected according to the world rankings when the deadline for entries closes on August 17. “Anytime you can bring women and men together on the same team, you showcase tennis at its best,” said USTA CEO Craig Tiley. Sinner, who did not enter last year’s mixed doubles, is “prioritising” his health ahead of the tournament.

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Zidane era begins for Les Bleus

FOOTBALL

Agence France-Presse PARIS

Zinedine Zidane was appointed France coach on Tuesday, as widely expected, following the departure of Didier Deschamps, the French Football Federation announced. Zidane, 54, had long been viewed as the leading candidate for the role and had been waiting for an opportunity to take charge of the national team for several years. Deschamps’ tenure, which began in 2012, ended earlier this month after France finished fourth at the World Cup. He guided France to 2018 World Cup glory and the final four years later. Zidane, Deschamps’



Zidane. REUTERS

teammate in the 1998 World Cup triumph, has been readying himself for the role since leaving Real Madrid in 2021. “The France job was the only one I wanted,” Zidane said after his unveiling at the FFF headquarters in Paris. “I’ve had offers over these four or five years to take charge of a club and I turned them all down for the French national team”.

Mancini returns as Italy coach

Reuters ROME

Former Italy manager Roberto Mancini will return for a second spell as national team coach, Italian Football Federation (FIGC) president Giovanni Malago said on Tuesday, while Claudio Ranieri will take over as technical director. Mancini will replace Gennaro Gattuso. Malago announced the appointment during a Federal Council meeting. “Mancini is the coach,” he said before confirming the decision at a press conference. “I believed that the best person to become head coach was Roberto Mancini.” The 61-year-old Mancini guided Italy to the European Championship title in 2021. He led Italy in 58 matches during his first spell and at club level has



Mancini. REUTERS

managed Inter Milan, Fiorentina and Manchester City, where he spent three years and guided it to its first Premier League title in 2011-12. Former FIGC technical director Paolo Maldini and adviser Leonardo resigned from their roles on Monday after their primary candidate for the Italy coach’s position, Andrea Pirlo, had his appointment blocked due to his ties to a Russian betting firm.

TVS launches mini bikes to help grassroots two-wheeler racing

S. Dipak Ragav CHENNAI

TVS Motor Company has launched the TVS Apache RR 200 Mini to help youngsters take the first step into motorsports. TVS gave away 10 mini bikes to the Madras Motor Sports Club in an event at the Madras International Karting Arena (MIKA) on Monday. The purpose-built TVS Apache RR 200 Mini will form the backbone of a structured rider development programme for aspiring racers aged 10-14 years, equipping them with professional racing skills under the guidance of experienced instructors and TVS Racing champions. They will also be provided with requisite safety gear. For a long time, India has not had access to mini



The first step: TVS gave away 10 mini bikes to the Madras Motor Sports Club on Monday. SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

bikes, which are crucial for riders’ development and are enjoyed by their peers in Europe and Southeast Asia. These bikes promise to fill that gap, offering aspirants a chance to train their skills at an earlier age. Young riders will be

trained at the MIKA karting track, with the option of the short loop version of the Madras International Circuit also available. “We are working to create a grassroots-level programme where the youngsters can be trained.

Now we want to build grassroots-level youngsters who can eventually become a part of Rookie Cup and the Factory Racing Team,” said Vimal Sumbly, Head – Premium Business, TVS Motor Company. “We are creating these

products to ensure the kids can get trained in the age group of 10 to 14. So this bucket of 10 to 14, which was not there with us, is what we are building it for. Through this, we also want to tell a larger audience that motorsports is a career to develop, provided you do a structured approach and get trained well,” he added. TVS Racing’s Jagan Kumar, an 11-time National champion, welcomed the introduction of this bike and felt it is a huge step for the riders. “For car racing, you have karts where kids can learn. But in bikes, until now we didn’t have one. If kids can start at 10, they can learn a lot of basics like body posture, cornering lines and throttle control, and these things will help them turn pro earlier,” said Jagan.

Corinthian obliges in the Colonel B. Santosh Babu Memorial Trophy

HYDERABAD: Mr. C. Aryama Sundaram-owned Corinthian, ridden by P. Trevor, won the Colonel B. Santosh Babu Memorial Trophy, the feature event of Tuesday’s (July 28) races here. The winner is trained by D. Netto. Jockeys Akshay Kumar and Trevor scored a treble each. Trainer Magan Singh Parmar saddled his 100th winner at the Hyderabad Race Course when his ward Ek won the fifth race today. 1. SHAMIRPET TROPHY (DIV. II) (1,200M): DARING SPIRIT (Suraj Nareded) (A. Naresb) 2, Mysore Pharoah (Ajay K) 3 and Cypress (Kuldeep Sr.) 4. 5-3/4, 4-1/2 and 1. Im, 15.2ls. ₹14 (w), 10, 13 and 19 (p). SHP: 36, THP: 60, FP: 49, Q: 39, Tanala: 259. Favourite: Daring Spirit. Owners: M/s. Arun Alagappan Racing LLP, Chandrakant Kankaria & Bhaskar Shyamraju. Trainer: A. Imran Khan. 2. SCARLET PRINCE PLATE (1,200M): ADVAIT (P. Trevor) 1, Master Class (Gaurav) 2, Northern Sky (Rafique Sk.) 3 and Twilight King (P. Ajeeth K) 4. 2-3/4, Neck and 3. Im, 14.43s. ₹25 (w), 13, 14 and 16 (p). SHP: 40, THP: 53, FP: 92, Q: 59, Tanala: 426. Favourite: Advait. Owner: Mr. Shantanu Sharma. Trainer: Bharat Singh. 3. FIRECREST PLATE (DIV. II)

(1,100M): GRIEF (P. Sai Kumar) 1, Dashing Charm (Akshay K) 2, Dubai Touch (Neeraj) 3 and Arthisha (B. Nikhil) 4. Not run: Sweet Dancer. 3/4, 3-3/4 and 2-1/4. Im, 07.56s. ₹15 (w), 10, 13 and 19 (p). SHP: 44, THP: 39, FP: 74, Q: 46, Tanala: 223. Favourite: Grief. Owners: M/s. S. Prasad Raju & Mukund Kakani. Trainer: K.S.V. Prasad Raju. 4. MALAKPET PLATE (1,600M): LA FLEURIERE (P. Trevor) 1, Divine Tiger (Akshay K) 2, Mountain Touch (Neeraj) 3 and Yuvraj (Kuldeep Sr.) 4. Neck, 3-1/2 and 2-1/2. Im, 42. 17s. ₹40 (w), 10, 18 and 18 (p). SHP: 34, THP: 50, FP: 135, Q: 45, Tanala: 337. Favourite: Divine Tiger. Owners: M/s. Sarainaga Racing Pvt. Ltd. Trainer: Bharat Singh. 5. SHAMIRPET TROPHY (DIV. I) (1,200M): EK (Akshay Kumar) 1, La Quinta (Ajay K) 2, Zindabad (B.R. Kumar) 3 and Valledonna (Trevor) 4. 5, 1-1/4 and 3/4. Im, 14.88s. ₹36 (w), 18, 17 and 12 (p). SHP: 51, THP: 55, FP: 101, Q: 64, Tanala: 571. Favourite: Zindabad. Owner: Mr. Syed Mohiuddin Mufeed. Trainer: Magan Singh. 6. ROYSTON ROCK PLATE (1,200M): N R I HIGH POWER (Akshay Kumar) 1, Brilliant Lad (Neeraj) 2, Walking Thunder (Trevor) 3 and D Minchu (B.R. Kumar) 4. 3/4, 3/4

and 1/2. Im, 13.99s. ₹20 (w), 12, 12 and 10 (p). SHP: 30, THP: 41, FP: 60, Q: 36, Tanala: 76. Favourite: N R I High Power. Owners: M/s. Ravinder Reddy Male, Suchit Jayraj Shah & Prabhakar Chowdary Tripuraneni. Trainer: D. Netto. 7. COLONEL B. SANTOSH BABU MEMORIAL TROPHY (1,400M): CORINTHIAN (P. Trevor) 1, Wolf Creek (Ashad Asbar) 2, China Town (Kuldeep Sr.) 3 and Glorious Power (Neeraj) 4. Not run: Torobravo. 3, 2 and 2-1/2. Im, 27.57s. ₹20 (w), 12, 16 and 47 (p). SHP: 43, THP: 43, FP: 51, Q: 29, Tanala: 707. Favourite: Corinthian. Owner: Mr. C. Aryama Sundaram. Trainer: R.H. Sequiera. Jackpot: 70%: ₹1,203 (300 tkts.), 30%: 279 (553 tkts.). Mini Jackpot: (i) 1,009 (63 tkts.), (ii) 325 (295 tkts.). Treble: (i) 86 (370 tkts.), (ii) 199 (92 tkts.), (iii) 56 (739 tkts.).



SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

Abdusattorov upbeat about the Olympiad at home

The former World rapid champion admits being under pressure for the showpiece but believes the Uzbekistan squad is capable of going the distance; the 21-year-old says he will help Sindarov prepare for the World championship match against Gukesh in Geneva from November 25 to December 15

B. VELANKANNI RAJ

C. Shyam Sundar

The “children” of Vishy Anand are on the loose! These were the words of Russian chess legend Garry Kasparov after Indian GM D. Gukesh had won the Candidates in circa 2024 before going on to capture the World title (later that year).

He was referring to the growing legion of Indian chess players, especially those under the tutelage of Anand, who were taking the sport by storm.

The year (2024) was a golden one for India as it topped the Open and women’s categories in the Budapest Olympiad before Gukesh dethroned Ding Liren in the championship match.

As the Indians were raising the bar, Uzbekistan was making

its presence felt with its players coming to the fore with impactful performances of their own.

Nodirbek Abdusattorov had probably struck the first blow for the Uzbeks, winning the World Rapid title in 2021 at the age of 17, becoming the youngest-ever to do so.

A year later in 2022, he was at the forefront as Uzbekistan emerged the surprise winner in the Open event in the Olympiad in Mamallapuram (near Chennai).

Abdusattorov and Javokhir Sindarov, who has emerged as a name to reckon within the last one year, will be spearheading Uzbekistan’s charge to regain the gold in the upcoming Olympiad at home (in Samarkand).

The former World rapid champion, who was in Chennai recently for the Grand Masters tournament in the city, is confident of the team doing well in the Olympiad.

Gearing up

He said the squad had already held several training camps in Uzbekistan. The team is likely to comprise the Candidates winner Sindarov, Nodirbek Yakubboev and Shamsiddin Vokhidov besides Abdusattorov, with Mukhiddin Madaminov as the reserve.

This line-up, he said, could mount a serious challenge for the top prize.

“Our nation, our people will cheer for us. We understand that there will be a lot of pressure, and the expectations are very high,” he said in an interaction. “But I think we are ready for this challenge. We have gained a lot of experience by playing under tension.”

Abdusattorov said he would be helping out Sindarov as he prepares for the World championship match against Gukesh in Geneva (November 25 to December 15).

“I had joined his training camp for a week before the Candidates. For the upcoming World championship match, for sure, I will be part of his team. I will be training with him. From my perspective, he’s my friend, he’s close to me, and I will do my best to help him.”

Sindarov, during an interaction with Indian journalists at Norway Chess, had said that he didn’t even consider himself to be the best player in Uzbekistan and made known his admiration for Abdusattorov, who was was a sort of a hero for the other players.

He also believes the camaraderie among the Uzbek players will help in the pursuit of an Olympiad gold at home.

“In Uzbekistan, we are all good friends. We try to take it in a good spirit. We don’t see each other as competition or rivalry or enemies. We don’t have any such ideas. Especially after becoming Olympiad champions in 2022, that

friendship became stronger,” he further said. As a result, he said Uzbekistan had an advantage over other teams.

With the country’s players performing well consistently over the years, Abdusattorov said, “We have grown up together when we were young and this generation is the golden generation for Uzbek chess.”

That friendship is evident when Abdusattorov speaks glowingly about Sindarov. He said they have known each other since they were very young and competed in various age-group events.

“We played a lot against each other from our young age and it’s good when you have a competition within your country because you get inspired, you learn from them, we try to train together and it helps us to improve and to show better results. Ultimately I think this is the main reason why we are having so many good results,” he said.

Throwing his weight behind his friend and compatriot Sindarov, he said, “If Javokhir becomes the World champion, I think it’s going to be an exceptional year for Uzbekistan.”

Slight advantage for Gukesh

Turning his attention to the upcoming World Championship match between Sindarov and Gukesh, Abdusattorov said the Indian GM’s experience (of having played the last title match) would give him a slight advantage.

“Gukesh’s experience of playing the last World championship match gives him a little advantage. I think a lot depends on what kind of form and shape they will be in closer to the match. Also depends on preparation and some other aspects. But, it will be a lot of fun, a lot of entertainment for the chess world,” he added.

Abdusattorov has enormous respect for former World champion Vladimir Kramnik, who was the captain of the Uzbekistan team during the last World Cup, saying he and the other players learnt a lot from him.

“Kramnik is a big figure in the chess world... he helped us individually with our openings. We learned a lot from him. He recommended some openings which fit my style.”

About Anand’s remark regarding the possibility of two Indians playing the World Championship match in the future, he said with a grin, “... In the long run, of course. Two Uzbeks, two Indians, two Americans. At some point, it’s all possible.”

Also, he is happy with the new Candidates’ qualification criteria and the new format for the World Cup.

“Now, they are trying to get more spots... it’s 224, so they are trying to get more spots and they are trying to reduce



the number of days. I think it’s a good decision.”

The 21-year-old Uzbek is in awe of the rise of Indian chess and said players like M. Pranesh, who scored over Gukesh in the Chennai Grand Masters, were incredibly strong.

“I think they (the Indian youngsters) are a bit underestimated and underrated. If they have a 2,650 rating, I see them as 2,700 already,” said Abdusattorov.

He said Pranesh is a very good player and added that “He has huge potential and is also a very good Blitz player.”

Candidates back in focus

Abdusattorov is planning to have a shot at the World title and aims to qualify for the next Candidates in this cycle.

“I’m looking forward to qualifying for the Candidates. But first of all, I want to enjoy the game and really get joy from it,” said Abdusattorov, who failed to qualify for the Candidates tournament in 2026.

The young Uzbek chess star was also happy to return to Chennai, a happy hunting ground for him and even thought of going to the hotel where he had stayed during the 2022 Olympiad.

“I even checked how far away the hotel is where I stayed four years ago. I had an idea that maybe I can go to the hotel to relive some good memories...”

He has come a long way since those heady days in the southern city four years ago. Abdusattorov is now among the elite in chess as the ‘golden generation’ of Uzbekistan is primed and ‘on the loose’ to unleash its power on the global stage.

THE GIST

Abdusattorov and Sindarov, who has emerged as a name to reckon within the last one year, will be spearheading Uzbekistan’s charge to regain the gold in the upcoming Olympiad at home in Samarkand

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A study has found that 90% of private schools in New Delhi are located near a site contaminated with lead, mercury, arsenic, and/or pesticides; as opposed to developed countries, the study found that in low- and middle-income countries, urban schools are 4- to 28-times more likely than rural schools to be near a toxic site

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